

Current Affairs Register The Hindu | June 18-22, 2026

Comprehensive UPSC Current Affairs Digest

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50 High | 39 Medium | 60 Lower relevance | 149 items total

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HIGH

US-Iran nuclear deal ends West Asia war

GS2 International Relations

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Historic US-mediated deal announced after months of negotiations, ending 8-month conflict with immediate ceasefire, Gaza blockade lifting, and regional stability framework.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

The United States and Iran reached a landmark framework agreement addressing Iran's nuclear enrichment program, sanctions relief, and regional peace. The deal includes immediate ceasefire in Gaza, lifting of blockade, prisoner exchange, and a comprehensive MoU on Strait of Hormuz management ensuring global oil trade security. UN Secretary-General hailed the agreement as a breakthrough for Middle East peace.

The agreement is seen as a potential revival of the JCPOA (Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action) framework originally signed in 2015 but withdrawn from by the US in 2018. Follow-up talks are being held in Switzerland with mediators from Pakistan and Qatar, with US Vice-President J.D. Vance, special envoy Steve Witkoff, and Jared Kushner leading negotiations with Iran's Parliamentary Speaker Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf and Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi.

■ TIMELINE

2015 — Original JCPOA signed between Iran and P5+1

2018 — US withdrew from JCPOA under Trump administration

2023 — 8-month West Asia conflict begins

2026 — US-Iran framework agreement announced, ceasefire implemented

■ STATIC THEORY

- Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT) obligates non-nuclear weapon states to not develop nuclear weapons
- JCPOA (Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action) is the formal name of the Iran nuclear deal
- Sanctions are economic and political penalties imposed to compel policy changes
- Regional stability in West Asia is critical for global energy security and maritime trade

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. US-Iran deal includes immediate ceasefire and lifting of Gaza blockade
2. Prisoner exchange is part of the agreement
3. Iran agrees to non-interference in Yemen and Lebanon
4. MoU on Strait of Hormuz ensures security of 20% of global oil trade
5. US seeks to lock Iran into negotiations over nuclear programme limits

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ The deal only covers nuclear enrichment limits
- ✓ The deal is comprehensive, covering nuclear limits, sanctions relief, regional peace (Gaza, Yemen, Lebanon), and Strait of Hormuz navigation framework
- ✗ This is a new agreement unrelated to past frameworks
- ✓ It is seen as a potential revival of the JCPOA framework originally signed in 2015
- ✗ The agreement only benefits Iran and the US

6. Talks held at Lake Lucerne, Switzerland with Pakistan and Qatar as mediators

7. Agreement hailed by UN Secretary-General as breakthrough for Middle East peace

✓ The deal has global implications for energy security (20% of global oil trade through Hormuz), regional stability, and humanitarian relief in Gaza

■ MAINS ANGLE

Analyse the significance of the US-Iran nuclear deal for regional stability in West Asia and its implications for India's energy security and strategic interests.

■ STUDY LINK

International Relations -> West Asia -> Iran Nuclear Deal and JCPOA

HIGH

Strait of Hormuz: Iran closure, MoU, India energy security

GS2/GS3
International
Relations

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Iran closed the Strait of Hormuz for one week citing territorial dispute with Saudi Arabia, then signed an MoU with India for alternate oil trade routes. Separate US-Iran MoU establishes joint monitoring mechanism for the critical oil chokepoint.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

The Strait of Hormuz emerged as a flashpoint when Iran temporarily closed it for a week due to territorial dispute with Saudi Arabia, affecting global oil supply chains. Subsequently, Iran signed an MoU with India for alternate oil trade routes, and a broader US-Iran MoU established a navigation framework with joint monitoring mechanism. Iran announced the Persian Gulf Strait Authority will be sole authority handling Strait transits.

The Strait of Hormuz is the world's most critical oil chokepoint, carrying 20% of global oil trade. It connects the Persian Gulf with the Gulf of Oman and the Arabian Sea. Historically, Iran has threatened to close the Strait during geopolitical tensions, using it as strategic leverage. The recent territorial dispute with Saudi Arabia led to temporary closure, prompting diplomatic interventions.

■ KEY DATA

Aspect	Detail
Location	Between Iran and Oman, connecting Persian Gulf with Arabian Sea
Width	Approximately 21 miles at narrowest point
Global oil trade	20% of world's petroleum passes through
Closure duration	One week (recent incident)
Key players	Iran, US, India, Saudi Arabia, Oman, Gulf states

■ STATIC THEORY

- Chokepoints are narrow passages of water connecting two larger bodies, critical for international shipping
- Energy security refers to uninterrupted availability of energy sources at affordable prices
- Freedom of navigation is a principle of international maritime law under UNCLOS
- Strategic autonomy requires diversification of energy sources and supply routes

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Strait of Hormuz carries 20% of global oil trade

■ UPSC TRAPS

✗ The Strait of Hormuz connects the Red Sea and Arabian Sea

2. Iran closed the Strait for one week citing territorial dispute with Saudi Arabia 3. India-Iran MoU signed for alternate oil trade routes 4. US-Iran MoU establishes joint monitoring mechanism with joint coast guard patrols 5. Framework includes freedom of navigation, advance notification of naval exercises, and conflict de-escalation protocol 6. International Maritime Organisation to provide technical support 7. Iran established Persian Gulf Strait Authority as sole authority for Strait transits 8. MoU envisages lifting sanctions on Iran and ships serving Iranian trade 9. Monetary Policy Committee in India expressed concern over Strait of Hormuz disruption impact on economy	✓ It connects the Persian Gulf with the Gulf of Oman and the Arabian Sea ✗ Only Iran controls the Strait of Hormuz ✓ Both Iran and Oman border the Strait; the new MoU framework involves multiple parties including the US and mandates Iranian talks with Oman and other Gulf states ✗ The closure was due to military conflict ✓ The closure was due to a territorial dispute with Saudi Arabia, not direct military conflict
■ MAINS ANGLE <i>Critically examine the geopolitical significance of the Strait of Hormuz for India's energy security and discuss the implications of recent Iran-India MoU on alternate trade routes.</i>	■ STUDY LINK International Relations -) West Asia -) Maritime Security and Energy Chokepoints

HIGH	PM Modi at G7 Summit as outreach partner and seafarers issue	GS2 International Relations
■ NEWS TRIGGER PM Modi attended the G7 Summit in Italy as an outreach partner, participating in discussions on climate change, digital economy, and global supply chain resilience. Met President Trump to discuss safety and early release of Indian seafarers detained in conflict zones.		
■ INTRO & ORIGIN Prime Minister Narendra Modi attended the G7 Summit as an outreach partner nation, engaging in multilateral discussions on key global issues. A significant bilateral meeting with US President Trump focused on the safety and early release of Indian seafarers detained in conflict zones, particularly those affected by Middle East tensions and Houthi attacks on commercial shipping in the Red Sea region. <i>India's participation in G7 summits as an outreach partner reflects its growing global stature and the grouping's recognition of India's role in addressing global challenges. The seafarers issue has become critical due to ongoing conflicts in the Middle East, with Indian maritime workers often caught in crossfire or detained due to sanctions and conflict-zone restrictions.</i>		
■ STATIC THEORY • G7 is a group of seven advanced economies: USA, UK, France, Germany, Italy, Canada, and Japan • Outreach partners are invited countries that participate in specific sessions but are not full members • Seafarers are protected under International Labour Organization conventions and maritime law • India is one of the largest suppliers of seafarers globally, with approximately 200,000 Indian seafarers working internationally		

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. PM Modi attended G7 Summit as outreach partner nation
2. Summit held in Italy
3. India participated in discussions on climate change, digital economy, and global supply chain resilience
4. PM Modi met President Trump at G7 to discuss Indian seafarers' safety
5. Discussion focused on safety and early release of Indian seafarers detained in conflict zones
6. Issue linked to Houthi attacks on commercial shipping in Red Sea region
7. Seafarers affected by Middle East tensions
8. Congress leader Rahul Gandhi met family of detained seafarer and assured raising issue in Parliament

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ India is a full member of the G7
- ✓ India participates as an outreach partner, not a full member; G7 comprises only seven advanced economies
- ✗ The seafarers issue is limited to Red Sea incidents
- ✓ The issue is broader, affecting Indian seafarers detained in various conflict zones across the Middle East due to sanctions, conflict-zone restrictions, and Houthi attacks
- ✗ Only the PM is addressing the seafarers issue
- ✓ The issue has broader political attention, with opposition leaders like Rahul Gandhi also meeting affected families and promising to raise the matter in Parliament

■ MAINS ANGLE

Discuss India's engagement with G7 as an outreach partner and analyse how it reflects India's growing global stature. Also examine the challenges faced by Indian seafarers in conflict zones and government's response.

■ STUDY LINK

International Relations -) Multilateralism -) G7 and Outreach Partnerships

HIGH

India-UK FTA and social security totalisation agreement

GS2 International Relations

■ NEWS TRIGGER

India-UK Free Trade Agreement set for implementation from July 15, 2026 after final ratification. Separate social security (totalisation) agreement signed during UK PM's India visit, allowing portability of pension contributions and eliminating dual taxation.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

India and the United Kingdom finalized their comprehensive Free Trade Agreement for implementation from July 15, 2026, covering 95% of tariff lines with elimination or significant reduction of customs duties. Additionally, a landmark social security (totalisation) agreement was signed, benefiting 50,000 Indian professionals in the UK by saving approximately Rs. 500 million annually through portability of pension contributions and elimination of dual social security taxation.

India-UK FTA negotiations were concluded after 14 rounds of talks, reflecting deepening bilateral ties post-Brexit as the UK seeks new trading partnerships. The social security agreement addresses a long-standing demand of the Indian diaspora, which numbers approximately 1.5 million in the UK, making it one of the largest Indian communities abroad.

■ KEY DATA

Agreement Type	Key Features
Free Trade Agreement	95% tariff lines covered; implementation from July 15, 2026; includes services, digital trade, investment

Agreement Type	Key Features
Social Security Agreement	Portability of pension contributions; eliminates dual taxation; covers National Insurance (UK) and EPF/EPS (India); reciprocal healthcare provisions; effective from April 1, 2026

■ STATIC THEORY

- Free Trade Agreements eliminate or reduce tariffs and trade barriers between countries
- Totalisation agreements prevent dual social security taxation and allow pension portability
- National Insurance is the UK's social security system
- EPF (Employees' Provident Fund) and EPS (Employees' Pension Scheme) are India's social security mechanisms
- Indian diaspora refers to people of Indian origin living outside India

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. India-UK FTA to be implemented from July 15, 2026
2. Agreement covers 95% of tariff lines with elimination or significant reduction of customs duties
3. Includes provisions on services trade, digital trade, and investment
4. Negotiations concluded after 14 rounds
5. Social security agreement signed during UK PM's India visit
6. Totalization agreement allows portability of pension contributions
7. Eliminates dual social security taxation
8. Covers National Insurance (UK) and EPF/EPS (India)
9. Reciprocal healthcare provisions included
10. Social security agreement takes effect from April 1, 2026
11. Benefits 50,000 Indian professionals in UK
12. Saves approximately Rs. 500 million annually
13. Indian diaspora in UK numbers approximately 1.5 million

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ FTA and social security agreement are the same
- ✓ These are two separate agreements; FTA deals with trade in goods and services, while the social security agreement deals specifically with pension portability and social security taxation
- ✗ The social security agreement only covers new workers
- ✓ It allows portability of pension contributions, meaning even past contributions can be transferred, benefiting existing workers
- ✗ Implementation dates are the same for both
- ✓ Social security agreement takes effect from April 1, 2026, while FTA implementation is from July 15, 2026

■ MAINS ANGLE

Analyse the strategic and economic significance of India-UK Free Trade Agreement. Also discuss how the social security (totalisation) agreement addresses the welfare concerns of Indian diaspora.

■ STUDY LINK

International Relations -> Bilateral Relations -> India-UK Relations and Trade

HIGH

India-US interim trade deal awaits final touches

GS2/GS3
International
Relations

■ NEWS TRIGGER

USTR Jamieson Greer to visit India June 23-24 for talks with Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal on finalising interim trade deal. Government sources indicate deal requires only final touches, but implementation is pending US tariff finalisation.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

The India-US interim trade deal is on the verge of completion, with US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer scheduled to visit India on June 23-24, 2026 for final negotiations with Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal. Government sources indicate the deal requires only final touches, but Commerce Minister Goyal has stated that India cannot implement the FTA until securing competitive advantage, citing concerns over recent US forced labour investigations and tariff policies.

India-US trade relations have faced challenges including trade deficits, tariff barriers, and market access issues. Both countries have been negotiating various trade frameworks to enhance bilateral commerce. The interim deal is seen as a stepping stone toward a comprehensive trade agreement, addressing immediate concerns while laying groundwork for deeper economic integration.

■ STATIC THEORY

- USTR (United States Trade Representative) is the US government agency responsible for trade policy
- Interim trade deals are partial agreements that address specific sectors or issues pending a comprehensive FTA
- Tariffs are taxes imposed on imported goods to protect domestic industries or raise revenue
- Forced labour investigations relate to supply chain compliance with human rights standards
- Competitive advantage refers to factors that allow a country to produce goods more efficiently or at lower cost

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. USTR Jamieson Greer visiting India June 23-24, 2026
2. Talks with Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal to finalize interim trade deal
3. Government sources say deal requires only final touches
4. Implementation is pending US tariff finalisation
5. Commerce Minister Goyal stated India cannot implement FTA until securing competitive advantage
6. Recent US forced labour investigations and tariff policies are concerns
7. Deal is interim in nature, not comprehensive FTA

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ The deal is fully finalized and ready for implementation
- ✓ While requiring only final touches, implementation is pending US tariff finalisation and India has concerns about securing competitive advantage
- ✗ This is a comprehensive Free Trade Agreement
- ✓ This is an interim trade deal, serving as a stepping stone toward a potential comprehensive agreement
- ✗ Only trade issues are under discussion
- ✓ Concerns extend to forced labour investigations and tariff policies, indicating broader supply chain and compliance issues

■ MAINS ANGLE

Examine the challenges in finalising the India-US interim trade deal and discuss how it can balance India's strategic autonomy with the need for deeper economic engagement with the United States.

■ STUDY LINK

International Relations -> Bilateral Relations -> India-US Trade Relations

HIGH

India-Russia RELOS reciprocal logistics agreement operationalised

GS3 International Relations

■ NEWS TRIGGER

India and Russia operationalised Reciprocal Exchange of Logistics Support (RELOS) agreement enabling mutual military logistics access including refueling, repair, and berthing for ships and aircraft.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

The RELOS (Reciprocal Exchange of Logistics Support) agreement between India and Russia has been operationalised, marking a significant deepening of defence cooperation. The agreement enables reciprocal access to military logistics facilities including refueling, repair, and berthing for ships and aircraft. This is similar to India's LEMOA (Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement) with the United States.

India has been pursuing logistics agreements with strategic partners to enhance operational reach and capability of its armed forces. LEMOA with the US was signed in 2016, and similar agreements have been concluded with France, Australia, and other countries. The RELOS with Russia reflects India's multi-aligned foreign policy and the enduring strategic partnership with Russia, particularly in the defence sector.

■ KEY DATA

Agreement	Country	Key Features
RELOS	Russia	Reciprocal logistics access for refueling, repair, berthing
LEMOA	USA	Logistics support for military operations
Similar agreements	France, Australia	Reciprocal logistics support

■ STATIC THEORY

- Logistics agreements facilitate mutual use of military facilities without establishing permanent bases
- They enhance operational reach and reduce costs for military operations and training
- Such agreements do not imply automatic military alliance or commitment to joint operations
- They are transactional in nature, requiring payment for services used
- India's multi-alignment strategy involves maintaining strategic partnerships with multiple powers

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. RELOS agreement now operational between India and Russia
2. Enables reciprocal access to military logistics facilities
3. Covers refueling, repair, and berthing for ships and aircraft
4. Similar to India's LEMOA with US
5. India has logistics agreements with multiple countries including US, France, and Australia
6. Agreement reflects deepening India-Russia defence cooperation
7. Does not imply permanent military base or automatic alliance

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ RELOS is only with Russia
- ✓ RELOS specifically is with Russia, but India has similar logistics agreements (like LEMOA) with US, France, Australia, and other countries
- ✗ The agreement means India will host permanent Russian military bases
- ✓ Logistics agreements provide access to facilities on a transactional basis; they do not establish permanent bases
- ✗ This agreement compromises India's strategic autonomy
- ✓ It reflects India's multi-alignment strategy of maintaining strategic partnerships with multiple powers without exclusive alliances

■ MAINS ANGLE

■ STUDY LINK

Discuss the strategic significance of India's RELOS agreement with Russia and how it fits into India's multi-aligned foreign policy framework in the context of its logistics agreements with other major powers.

International Relations -) Defence Cooperation
-) Logistics Support Agreements

HIGH

India calls Pakistan Frankenstein state at UN; panel review

GS2 International
Relations

■ NEWS TRIGGER

India slammed Pakistan at United Nations calling it a Frankenstein state that gets shocked when its own monster bites back, accusing Islamabad of hosting, training and deploying terrorists. Separately, Parliamentary Standing Committee on External Affairs questioned Foreign Secretary on government's Pakistan engagement policy.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

In a strong rebuke at the United Nations, India's First Secretary at the Permanent Mission, Anupama Singh, called Pakistan a Frankenstein state, accusing it of hosting, training and deploying terrorists and being shocked when its own creation turns against it. The remarks were made after Pakistan and the Organisation of Islamic Cooperation (OIC) raised the issue of Jammu and Kashmir. Simultaneously, the Parliamentary Standing Committee on External Affairs questioned Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri on whether the government is considering people-to-people ties with Pakistan, with ministry officials confirming that Track-II diplomacy by non-governmental groups has continued.

India-Pakistan relations have been marked by multiple conflicts and persistent tensions, primarily over terrorism and the Kashmir issue. Pakistan has been repeatedly accused by India of sponsoring cross-border terrorism. The Frankenstein metaphor refers to the literary monster that turned against its creator, used here to describe Pakistan's alleged support for terrorist groups that have also targeted Pakistani interests.

■ STATIC THEORY

- Track-II diplomacy refers to unofficial, non-governmental channels of dialogue between countries
- The Organisation of Islamic Cooperation (OIC) is an international organization of 57 Muslim-majority countries
- UN General Assembly provides a platform for member states to raise bilateral and global issues
- State-sponsored terrorism refers to government support, directly or indirectly, for terrorist groups
- Parliamentary Standing Committees oversee government policies and can summon officials for questioning

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Anupama Singh, First Secretary at India's Permanent Mission to UN, made the remarks
2. India called Pakistan a Frankenstein state that is shocked when its own monster bites back
3. Accusation of Pakistan hosting, training and deploying terrorists
4. Remarks made after Pakistan and OIC raised issue of Jammu and Kashmir at UN
5. Parliamentary Standing Committee on External Affairs questioned Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri
6. Questions raised on whether PM Modi would attend SCO Summit in Pakistan

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ India has completely cut off all engagement with Pakistan
- ✓ While official diplomatic engagement is limited, Track-II diplomacy by non-governmental groups has continued
- ✗ The Frankenstein reference is about Pakistan's nuclear program
- ✓ The metaphor refers to Pakistan's alleged support for terrorist groups that have also turned against Pakistani interests
- ✗ Only India raised Pakistan at the UN
- ✓ Pakistan and OIC first raised the Kashmir issue, prompting India's strong response

7. Ministry officials said Track-II diplomacy by non-governmental groups has continued with Pakistan

8. Parliamentary panel seeks clarity on government's Pakistan engagement policy

■ MAINS ANGLE

Critically analyse India's Pakistan policy balancing strong responses to terrorism with the need for regional stability. Discuss the role of Track-II diplomacy in India-Pakistan relations.

■ STUDY LINK

International Relations -) Bilateral Relations -)
India-Pakistan Relations and Cross-Border
Terrorism

HIGH

Vivek Aggarwal appointed FATF Vice-President 2026-27

GS2 International
Relations

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Financial Action Task Force (FATF) Plenary appointed Union Culture Secretary Vivek Aggarwal as next Vice-President of the global anti-money laundering and counter-terrorist financing watchdog for the 2026-2027 term.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Vivek Aggarwal, Union Culture Secretary, has been appointed as Vice-President of the Financial Action Task Force (FATF) for the 2026-2027 term. He will succeed Giles Thomson who served as FATF Vice-President since July 1, 2025. This appointment reflects India's growing role in global financial governance and the fight against money laundering and terrorist financing.

FATF is an inter-governmental body established in 1989 by the G7 to develop policies to combat money laundering and, later, terrorist financing. It sets international standards and promotes effective implementation of legal, regulatory and operational measures. India has been a member since 2010 and has progressively taken on leadership roles, with this Vice-President position being a significant step toward potential future Presidency.

■ KEY DATA

Aspect	Detail
Organisation	Financial Action Task Force (FATF)
Established	1989 by G7
India's membership	Since 2010
Appointee	Vivek Aggarwal, Union Culture Secretary
Position	Vice-President for 2026-2027
Predecessor	Giles Thomson (served since July 1, 2025)

■ STATIC THEORY

- FATF is the global standard-setting body for anti-money laundering and counter-terrorist financing (AML/CFT)
- Money laundering is the process of concealing the origins of illegally obtained money
- Terrorist financing refers to providing financial support to terrorist activities
- FATF maintains grey and black lists of jurisdictions with strategic AML/CFT deficiencies
- Member countries are periodically reviewed through mutual evaluation processes

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Vivek Aggarwal appointed FATF Vice-President for 2026-2027 term

■ UPSC TRAPS

✗ Vivek Aggarwal is from the Finance Ministry

2. Currently serving as Union Culture Secretary 3. Will succeed Giles Thomson who served since July 1, 2025 4. FATF is global anti-money laundering and counter-terrorist financing watchdog 5. Appointment reflects India's growing role in global financial governance 6. FATF established in 1989 by G7 7. India became FATF member in 2010	✓ He currently serves as Union Culture Secretary, not from Finance Ministry ✗ FATF only deals with money laundering ✓ FATF addresses both anti-money laundering (AML) and counter-terrorist financing (CFT) ✗ India has been a founding member of FATF ✓ FATF was founded in 1989 by G7; India became a member in 2010
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■ MAINS ANGLE

Discuss the significance of India's appointment to the Vice-President position in FATF and how it enhances India's role in global financial governance and the fight against illicit financial flows.

■ STUDY LINK

International Relations -) International Organizations -) FATF and Financial Governance

HIGH

Italy-US tariff row at G7; Lebanon ceasefire violations

GS2 International Relations

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Italy and the United States engaged in a sharp diplomatic row over US trade tariffs on Italian luxury goods during the G7 Summit held in Italy. Separately, Israeli strikes on southern Lebanon killed 16 people including 4 children despite a ceasefire agreement brokered three weeks ago.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

The G7 Summit in Italy was overshadowed by a diplomatic confrontation between host Italy and the United States over US-imposed 25% tariffs on Italian fashion and wine products. Italy threatened retaliatory measures, straining transatlantic relations. Concurrently, the fragile peace in Lebanon was shattered by Israeli strikes that killed 16 people including 4 children, despite a ceasefire agreement brokered three weeks earlier. Lebanon's government condemned the attacks as violations of international law, with UN peacekeeping forces calling for restraint.

The US under recent administrations has increasingly used tariffs as a tool of economic policy and geopolitical leverage, often affecting traditional allies. The luxury goods tariff on Italy reflects ongoing US-EU trade tensions. The Lebanon ceasefire is part of broader West Asia peace efforts, but repeated violations indicate the fragility of such agreements and the persistence of underlying conflicts between Israel and various regional actors.

■ KEY DATA

Issue	Key Facts
Italy-US tariff row	US imposed 25% tariffs on Italian fashion and wine; diplomatic confrontation at G7; Italy threatened retaliation
Lebanon ceasefire violations	Israeli strikes killed 16 including 4 children; ceasefire brokered 3 weeks ago; Lebanon condemned as international law violation; UN peacekeeping forces called for restraint

■ STATIC THEORY

- G7 is a forum for coordination among major advanced economies on economic and security issues
- Tariffs are taxes on imports used for protectionism or as bargaining tools in trade negotiations
- Ceasefire agreements are formal arrangements to stop fighting, often fragile without addressing root causes

- International humanitarian law prohibits targeting civilians and requires proportionality in military actions
- UN peacekeeping forces are deployed to maintain peace and monitor ceasefires

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Italy-US diplomatic confrontation occurred during G7 Summit held in Italy
2. US imposed 25% tariffs on Italian luxury goods (fashion and wine products)
3. Italy threatened retaliatory measures
4. Israeli strikes on southern Lebanon killed 16 people including 4 children
5. Strikes occurred despite ceasefire agreement brokered three weeks earlier
6. Lebanon government condemned attacks as violations of international law
7. UN peacekeeping forces called for restraint
8. US-Iran deal included Iran's agreement to non-interference in Lebanon

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ The Italy-US tariff dispute is about energy products
- ✓ The dispute concerns tariffs on Italian luxury goods, specifically fashion and wine products
- ✗ The Lebanon ceasefire has been in place for years
- ✓ The ceasefire was brokered only three weeks before the violations, indicating its recent and fragile nature
- ✗ These two issues are directly connected
- ✓ While both occurred around the same time and involve international tensions, they are separate issues - one concerning transatlantic trade relations, the other West Asia security

■ MAINS ANGLE

Analyse how trade tensions between traditional allies like the US and EU members can undermine multilateral cooperation. Separately, discuss the challenges in maintaining ceasefires in West Asia and the role of international law and peacekeeping.

■ STUDY LINK

International Relations -> Global Issues -> Trade Wars and Middle East Peace Process

HIGH

Telegram ban upheld under IT Act Section 69A

GS2 Polity & Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Delhi High Court upheld the Centre's temporary platform-wide ban on Telegram under Section 69A of the IT Act, linked to organised cheating networks in the NEET-UG 2026 paper leak (order of June 16, 2026).

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

The Ministry of Electronics and IT ordered a seven-day block of Telegram after a probe found the NEET-UG 2026 paper leaked through 50-plus groups. The MHA issued a notification; the petitioner argued the ban violates Article 19(1)(a).

Section 69A of the IT Act, 2000 empowers the Centre to block public access to information in the interest of sovereignty, security and public order, through the 2009 Blocking Rules. The Supreme Court upheld 69A with procedural safeguards in Shreya Singhal (2015).

■ TIMELINE

2000 — IT Act enacted; Section 69A added by 2008 amendment

2009 — Information Technology Blocking Rules notified

2015 — Shreya Singhal upholds Section 69A with safeguards

2026 — June 16 block order; Delhi HC upholds platform-wide ban

■ STATIC THEORY

- Section 69A permits blocking on grounds of sovereignty, defence, security, public order, friendly relations and to prevent incitement
- Procedure is governed by the IT (Blocking) Rules, 2009, requiring recorded reasons
- Article 19(1)(a) free speech is subject to reasonable restrictions under Article 19(2)
- Section 79 separately governs intermediary safe-harbour, distinct from 69A blocking

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. MeitY ordered a seven-day block; NTA filed a complaint under the IT Act
2. Over 50 Telegram groups were found sharing question papers before the exam
3. Delhi HC held the Act's broad definition of 'information' covers software and computer programmes, allowing blocking of an entire platform
4. Order issued June 16, 2026 and challenged by Telegram; petitioner cited Article 19(1)(a)
5. Court noted operators created mirror channels and backup groups after enforcement

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ The ban was imposed under the Telecommunications Act
- ✓ It was imposed under Section 69A of the IT Act, 2000 via the 2009 Blocking Rules
- ✗ Section 69A allows blocking only specific content, not whole platforms
- ✓ The Delhi HC held 'information' is broad enough to cover software, permitting platform-wide blocking
- ✗ Section 69A and Section 79 are the same provision
- ✓ 69A is blocking power; 79 is intermediary safe-harbour

■ MAINS ANGLE

Balancing exam integrity and national security with free speech and proportionality when blocking entire digital platforms.

■ STUDY LINK

Polity -) Fundamental Rights -) Article 19(1)(a) and IT Act Section 69A

HIGH

NEET-UG 2026 re-test ordered amid leak controversy

GS2 Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

The NTA scheduled a Supreme Court-monitored NEET-UG 2026 re-test for affected candidates on June 23, 2026, after a paper leak and time-loss irregularities; the SC declined to defer the process.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

The re-exam covers candidates from Patna, Godhra and four other cities where irregularities were reported, at 55 centres, with results promised within 48 hours. The original exam was held on May 5 with about 24 lakh candidates amid grace-marks and leak disputes.

The National Testing Agency (NTA) was set up in 2017 to conduct major entrance exams. NEET-UG is the single national medical entrance under the National Medical Commission framework, drawing criticism over single high-stakes design.

■ TIMELINE

2017 — National Testing Agency established

2026 — NEET-UG held May 5; leak via Telegram groups

2026 — Re-test scheduled June 23, results in 48 hours

■ STATIC THEORY

- NTA conducts NEET-UG, JEE, CUET and other national tests
- NEET-UG is mandated under the NMC Act for MBBS/BDS admissions
- Single high-stakes exams raise questions of security, equity and federal friction
- Supreme Court monitoring is used to ensure transparency in exam disputes

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Re-exam on June 23, 2026 at 55 centres for the affected candidates
2. Patna and Godhra were among the irregularity epicentres
3. Results to be declared within 48 hours; process is SC-monitored
4. Original NEET held May 5 with about 24 lakh candidates
5. NTA filed a complaint after the leak spread through Telegram

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ The MCI regulates NEET-UG
- ✓ The NMC replaced the MCI; the NTA conducts the exam
- ✗ All candidates must re-sit the exam
- ✓ Only candidates affected by irregularities take the re-test

■ MAINS ANGLE

Examination integrity and reform of high-stakes single-test systems, and the NTA's accountability.

■ STUDY LINK

Governance -) Education -) NTA and NEET regulatory accountability

HIGH

20 Trinamool MPs merge with NCPI; anti-defection test

GS2 Polity

■ NEWS TRIGGER

20 Lok Sabha MPs elected on a Trinamool Congress ticket declared a merger with the Nationalist Citizens Party of India (NCPI) and aligned with the NDA, triggering a disqualification petition.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

The group of 20 is exactly two-thirds of Trinamool's 28 Lok Sabha MPs. Led by four-time MP Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar, the move invokes the Tenth Schedule's merger exception. In parallel, the Shiv Sena (UBT) raised concern over possible defection of six of its 18 MPs.

The Tenth Schedule (anti-defection) was added by the 52nd Amendment, 1985. The 91st Amendment, 2003 deleted the one-third 'split' exemption, leaving only the two-thirds 'merger' defence against disqualification.

■ TIMELINE

- 1985** — 52nd Amendment inserts the Tenth Schedule
- 2003** — 91st Amendment removes the split exemption
- 2026** — 20 TMC MPs declare merger with NCPI

■ STATIC THEORY

- Disqualification grounds: voluntarily giving up membership or defying a whip
- Merger is valid only if two-thirds of the party agrees
- The Speaker or Chairman adjudicates, acting as a tribunal
- Kihoto Hollohan (1992) made the Speaker's decision subject to judicial review

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

■ UPSC TRAPS

1. 20 of 28 MPs equals exactly two-thirds, meeting the merger threshold 2. Led by Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar; group aligned with the BJP-led NDA 3. Abhishek Banerjee submitted the disqualification petition to Speaker Om Birla 4. The 91st Amendment, 2003 removed the one-third split defence 5. Two-thirds of the political party, not just the legislature party, must agree to merger	✗ A one-third split still protects defectors ✓ The 91st Amendment, 2003 removed the split defence; only a two-thirds merger is valid ✗ Courts cannot review the Speaker's decision ✓ Kihoto Hollohan (1992) allows judicial review of the Speaker's order ✗ Only the legislature party must agree to a merger ✓ The Constitution requires two-thirds of the original political party to agree
■ MAINS ANGLE <i>Whether mass mergers defeat the anti-defection law's intent and the Speaker's neutrality in adjudication.</i>	■ STUDY LINK Polity -) Tenth Schedule -) Anti-defection and the 91st Amendment

HIGH	Karnataka MLC cross-voting roils BJP	GS2 Polity
■ NEWS TRIGGER Congress won five of seven Karnataka Legislative Council seats (MLA quota) amid cross-voting; the BJP took two and summoned State leaders to Delhi, forming a fact-finding panel under C.T. Ravi.		
■ INTRO & ORIGIN BJP State chief B.Y. Vijayendra said four to five BJP legislators cross-voted, and H.D. Kumaraswamy said four JD(S) MLAs did too. Polling was by secret ballot, making whip enforcement difficult. Congress now has a majority in the 75-member Council. <i>Article 171 provides for State Legislative Councils. MLA-quota MLC seats are filled by proportional representation through the single transferable vote by secret ballot, unlike the open ballot used for Rajya Sabha since 2003.</i>		
■ STATIC THEORY • Articles 168-171 govern State Legislative Councils and their composition • MLC members come from six categories including the MLA-elected quota • Elections use proportional representation by single transferable vote • Anti-defection applies to defying a whip or voluntarily giving up membership		
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS 1. Seven seats polled: Congress five, BJP two 2. Voting was by secret ballot 3. BJP set up a fact-finding panel under C.T. Ravi, MLC 4. Congress secured a majority in the 75-member Legislative Council	■ UPSC TRAPS ✗ MLA-quota MLC polls use an open ballot like the Rajya Sabha ✓ They use a secret ballot, making whip enforcement weaker ✗ A party can form government on Legislative Council strength ✓ Government formation rests on the Assembly, not the Council	

5. Kumaraswamy alleged four JD(S) MLAs also cross-voted

■ MAINS ANGLE

Utility of bicameralism at the State level and party discipline in secret-ballot indirect elections.

■ STUDY LINK

Polity -) State Legislature -) Article 171
Legislative Council

HIGH

SC: walking on footpaths a fundamental right

GS2 Polity

■ NEWS TRIGGER

The Supreme Court (Justice P.S. Narasimha) declared the freedom to walk on demarcated, well-maintained footpaths a fundamental right under Article 21, overriding the privilege of motorised vehicles.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

The ruling came in the case of a five-year-old boy crushed by a truck while walking to school with his father. The Court urged a statutory framework recognising the right to walk and identifying duty-bearers, and awarded compensation of over Rs.11 lakh.

Article 21's guarantee of life and personal liberty has been expansively read since Maneka Gandhi (1978) to include dignity, a clean environment and safe mobility, with positive obligations on the State.

■ STATIC THEORY

- Article 21 has been expanded to cover unenumerated rights
- The State carries positive duties to protect life and safety
- Urban road design must prioritise pedestrians and vulnerable users
- Compensation under Article 21 follows from State or systemic failure

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Judgment authored by Justice P.S. Narasimha
2. Right to walk on footpaths overrides the privilege of motorised vehicles
3. Court called for a statutory framework and duty-bearers
4. Compensation of over Rs.11 lakh awarded to the parent

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ A constitutional amendment created this right
- ✓ It is judicial expansion of Article 21, not a new amendment
- ✗ Article 21 only covers enumerated rights
- ✓ It includes unenumerated rights read in through interpretation

■ MAINS ANGLE

Pedestrian-first urban design and the State's positive obligations under Article 21 for road safety.

■ STUDY LINK

Polity -) Article 21 -) Expanding fundamental rights

HIGH

SC reaffirms UAPA bail via K.A. Najeeb precedent

GS2 Polity

■ NEWS TRIGGER

The Supreme Court heard a UAPA bail plea citing the K.A. Najeeb precedent that prolonged pre-trial detention violates personal liberty even under stringent laws.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

The Court emphasised the constitutional right to a speedy trial for an accused detained for years without trial completion, signalling that constitutional courts can grant bail despite the Section 43D(5) bar.

The UAPA, 1967 contains a stringent bail bar under Section 43D(5). NIA v. Zahoor Watali (2019) set a strict merits test, while K.A. Najeeb (2021) carved out relief where trial is unduly delayed.

■ STATIC THEORY

- Section 43D(5) restricts bail if a prima facie case exists
- Constitutional courts can grant bail to protect Article 21 liberty
- Right to speedy trial is part of Article 21
- Statutory bar and constitutional bail can coexist

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. K.A. Najeeb is a Supreme Court precedent on UAPA bail
2. Prolonged detention without trial can justify bail despite Section 43D(5)
3. Right to speedy trial flows from Article 21
4. Zahoor Watali (2019) lays down the strict merits standard

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Section 43D(5) makes bail impossible under UAPA
- ✓ Najeeb allows constitutional courts to grant bail when trial is delayed
- ✗ Najeeb overruled Watali
- ✓ Both coexist: Watali on merits, Najeeb on delay-based liberty

■ MAINS ANGLE

Reconciling personal liberty and the right to speedy trial with security imperatives under stringent laws.

■ STUDY LINK

Polity -) Article 21 -) UAPA bail and speedy trial

HIGH

SC orders Young Lawyers' Professional Assistance Fund

GS2 Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

The Supreme Court (CJI Surya Kant and Justice V. Mohana) directed every State and Union Territory to create a Young Lawyers' Professional Assistance Fund to address financial hardship faced by new lawyers.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

The Court noted the initial years impose severe hardship, especially on first-generation lawyers and those from disadvantaged backgrounds. The fund is to be placed under High Courts or an autonomous body, on a self-sustaining model where beneficiaries contribute back later.

Access to justice under Article 39A and Bar welfare have long been concerns, with entry barriers high for first-generation entrants to the legal profession.

■ STATIC THEORY

- Article 39A directs the State to ensure access to justice and free legal aid
- Bar Councils administer welfare measures for advocates
- Judicial directions can mandate welfare structures
- Self-sustaining funds reduce long-term fiscal burden

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

■ UPSC TRAPS

1. Bench of CJI Surya Kant and Justice V. Mohana issued the directions 2. A fund is to be set up in every State and Union Territory 3. It will be placed under High Courts or an autonomous body 4. A self-sustaining model lets assisted lawyers contribute back 5. Directions came on a petition by six women lawyers	✗ Parliament legislated this fund ✓ It stems from a Supreme Court direction, not legislation ✗ The fund sits with Bar Councils alone ✓ It is placed under High Courts or an autonomous body
■ MAINS ANGLE <i>Strengthening access to justice by supporting first-generation lawyers and a robust Bar.</i>	■ STUDY LINK Polity -) Article 39A -) Access to justice and the legal profession

HIGH Madhya Pradesh prepares Uniform Civil Code Bill GS2 Polity	
■ NEWS TRIGGER The Madhya Pradesh government drafted a Uniform Civil Code Bill ahead of the Monsoon Session (July 20-24, 2026), seeking uniform civil laws across religions.	
■ INTRO & ORIGIN The Bill aims to provide uniform rules on marriage, divorce, succession and adoption across communities, following Uttarakhand's UCC implementation earlier in the year. <i>Article 44, a Directive Principle, asks the State to endeavour to secure a Uniform Civil Code. The debate runs from the Hindu Code Bills of the 1950s through Shah Bano (1985) to Uttarakhand's 2024 UCC.</i>	■ TIMELINE 1950s — Hindu Code Bills reform Hindu personal law 1985 — Shah Bano case revives the UCC debate 2024 — Uttarakhand implements a UCC 2026 — Madhya Pradesh drafts a UCC Bill
■ STATIC THEORY • Article 44 is a non-justiciable Directive Principle • Personal laws fall under Entry 5 of the Concurrent List • Goa already follows a common civil code • UCC seeks uniformity across marriage, divorce, succession and adoption	
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS 1. M.P. drafted the UCC Bill for the Monsoon Session (July 20-24) 2. Covers marriage, divorce, succession and adoption across religions 3. Follows Uttarakhand's UCC 4. Article 44 places UCC among Directive Principles	■ UPSC TRAPS ✗ Article 44 is a justiciable fundamental right ✓ It is a non-justiciable Directive Principle of State Policy ✗ No Indian State has a common civil code ✓ Goa has long followed a common civil code
■ MAINS ANGLE	■ STUDY LINK

HIGH

Only 10% women candidates despite Reservation Act

GS2 Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Despite the 2023 Women's Reservation Act reserving 33% of seats, parties fielded only about 10% women candidates, per ADR data for the 2024 Lok Sabha and 14 State Assembly elections.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

The Act mandates reservation only after the next census and delimitation, so it is not yet operational. Women's groups are demanding immediate implementation, citing the persistent representation gap.

The Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam was passed as the 106th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2023, after the proposal had been pending since 1996, inserting reservation provisions for women.

■ STATIC THEORY

- The 106th Amendment reserves one-third of seats for women
- Implementation is contingent on a census and delimitation
- Reserved seats are to rotate across constituencies
- Representation can be descriptive or substantive

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Data compiled by the Association for Democratic Reforms (ADR)
2. Act reserves 33% of seats for women
3. Only about 10% women candidates were fielded in recent polls
4. Reservation takes effect after census and delimitation
5. It applies to the Lok Sabha and State Assemblies

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ The reservation is already in force
- ✓ It applies only after a census and delimitation are completed
- ✗ It covers the Rajya Sabha and Legislative Councils
- ✓ It applies only to the Lok Sabha and State Assemblies

■ MAINS ANGLE

Closing the gender gap in legislatures and whether parties act beyond statutory quotas.

■ STUDY LINK

Polity -) 106th Amendment -) Women's Reservation

HIGH

Census 2027 digital phase: field challenges

GS2 Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

First fully digital Census of India underway with 33 lakh enumerators conducting Houselisting and Housing Operations phase, reporting field challenges.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

India's first fully digital census, originally scheduled for 2021, is now being conducted six years late. The Houselisting and Housing Operations phase involves a 33-question survey covering housing conditions, household composition, and basic amenities.

Population Census in India dates to 1872. Post-independence, decennial censuses have been conducted every 10 years starting 1951. Census 2021 was postponed due to COVID-19 pandemic. Census 2027 marks shift from paper-based to fully digital enumeration using tablets and mobile devices.

■ STATIC THEORY

- Census provides demographic, social and economic data for policy planning
- Houselisting phase precedes Population Enumeration phase
- Enumerators are typically government teachers and officials
- Data informs delimitation, fund allocation, and welfare schemes

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. 33 lakh enumerators deployed across India
2. Rs.25,000 honorarium per enumerator
3. 33-question survey on housing, amenities, assets
4. Population Enumeration phase scheduled February 2027 will include caste data
5. 23 States and UTs completed first phase by June 2026
6. Enumerators reported heat, connectivity issues, safety concerns, and pressure to edit data on sanitation and electricity

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Census 2027 includes caste enumeration in HLO phase
- ✓ Caste enumeration deferred to Population Enumeration phase in Feb 2027
- ✗ Census postponed by 2 years
- ✓ Census postponed by 6 years from 2021 to 2027

■ MAINS ANGLE

Digital Census 2027 presents opportunity for real-time data but faces challenges of connectivity, data accuracy pressure, and enumerator safety in field conditions.

■ STUDY LINK

Governance -) Census of India -) Digital Census and Data Collection

HIGH

NFHS-6 nutrition and child health data

GS2 Health

■ NEWS TRIGGER

National Family Health Survey-6 data reveals mixed progress: child stunting declined from 35.5% to 32.1%, but anemia among women remains high at 57%.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

NFHS-6 is a large-scale, multi-round survey covering all states and union territories. It provides state and district-level estimates on fertility, mortality, family planning, reproductive health, nutrition, and health care.

NFHS conducted under Ministry of Health and Family Welfare since 1992-93. Previous rounds: NFHS-1 (1992-93), NFHS-2 (1998-99), NFHS-3 (2005-06), NFHS-4 (2015-16), NFHS-5 (2019-21). NFHS-6 represents sixth iteration of this critical health surveillance system.

■ STATIC THEORY

- NFHS is equivalent of Demographic and Health Surveys (DHS) conducted globally
- Survey uses two-stage stratified sampling design
- Key indicators: IMR, MMR, TFR, institutional deliveries, child nutrition
- Data used for monitoring SDG targets related to health

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS 1. NFHS-6 covered 7.2 lakh households across India 2. Child stunting declined from 35.5% to 32.1% 3. Child wasting reduced from 19.3% to 18.7% 4. Infant Mortality Rate dropped to 28 per 1,000 live births 5. Anemia among women remains high at 57% 6. Institutional deliveries increased to 91.3% 7. Survey highlights regional disparities with northern states lagging	■ UPSC TRAPS ✗ NFHS-6 shows anemia declining among women ✓ Anemia remains high at 57% despite other improvements ✗ All health indicators improved uniformly across India ✓ Regional disparities persist; northern states lag behind
■ MAINS ANGLE While NFHS-6 shows progress on child mortality and stunting, persistent anemia and regional disparities require targeted interventions in maternal nutrition and healthcare access.	■ STUDY LINK Health -) National Health Surveys -) NFHS and Health Indicators

HIGH Abhigyan app: NAFIS instant fingerprint verification GS3 Internal Security	
■ NEWS TRIGGER Home Minister Amit Shah launched Abhigyan app enabling police to verify criminal records instantly using fingerprint scanners linked to NAFIS database of 1.3 crore suspects and convicts.	
■ INTRO & ORIGIN Abhigyan app represents a significant advancement in policing technology, allowing field officers to instantly identify suspects and verify criminal history using biometric authentication. The app is integrated with the National Automated Fingerprint Identification System. <i>NAFIS launched by NCRB in 2020 to create centralized fingerprint repository. Criminal Procedure (Identification) Act, 2022 replaced archaic Identification of Prisoners Act, 1920, expanding scope of measurements to include biological samples. Abhigyan app is latest tech layer built on this legal and infrastructure foundation.</i>	■ TIMELINE 1920 — Identification of Prisoners Act enacted 2020 — NAFIS launched by NCRB 2022 — Criminal Procedure Identification Act replaces 1920 Act 2026 — Abhigyan app launched for instant field verification
■ STATIC THEORY • NAFIS is world's largest fingerprint database for law enforcement • CrPC Identification Act 2022 permits collection of fingerprints, palm prints, iris scans, biological samples • NCRB is nodal agency for crime statistics and criminal databases • Biometric identification improves conviction rates and deters repeat offenses	
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS	■ UPSC TRAPS

1. Abhigyan app developed by National Crime Records Bureau 2. Linked to NAFIS database of over 1.3 crore suspects and convicts 3. Fingerprint matching completed in 35 seconds 4. 1,556 workstations deployed at police stations and district headquarters 5. Legal basis: Criminal Procedure Identification Act, 2022 6. App secured with two-step authentication	✗ Abhigyan covers facial recognition ✓ Abhigyan currently covers only fingerprint-based verification ✗ App available to all citizens for verification ✓ App restricted to authorized police personnel with two-step authentication
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■ MAINS ANGLE

Abhigyan app exemplifies use of technology for public safety, but raises questions on data privacy, misuse, and need for robust legal safeguards under Identification Act 2022.

■ STUDY LINK

Internal Security -) Policing and Law Enforcement -) NAFIS and Criminal Databases

HIGH

Delhi L-G: 20% job quota for ex-Agniveers

GS2 Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Delhi Lieutenant Governor VK Saxena ordered 20% reservation in Group C government posts for Agniveer veterans with 5-year age relaxation.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

The reservation order applies to Delhi government departments and autonomous bodies, covering non-gazetted Group C posts. It aims to provide employment security to Agniveers after their 4-year military tenure under the Agnipath scheme.

Agnipath scheme launched in June 2022 by Ministry of Defence for recruitment into Armed Forces on short-term contractual basis. Agniveers serve 4-year tenure; 25% retained for regular cadre. Scheme faced initial resistance over lack of pension and post-service employment. Several states announced job quotas to address concerns.

■ TIMELINE

2022 — Agnipath scheme launched in June

2026 — First batch of Agniveers completes 4-year tenure

2026 — Delhi L-G orders 20% reservation in June

■ STATIC THEORY

- Group C posts are non-gazetted positions in government
- Lieutenant Governor exercises executive powers in Union Territory of Delhi
- Age relaxation is standard feature in reservation policies
- Ex-servicemen quotas exist in central and state governments since 1979

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Order issued by L-G VK Saxena under administrative powers
2. 20% quota in Group C non-gazetted posts

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Reservation applies to all government posts including IAS/IPS
- ✓ Reservation restricted to Group C non-gazetted posts only

3. Applicable to Delhi government departments and autonomous bodies 4. 5-year age relaxation for ex-Agniveers 5. Implementation from next recruitment cycle 6. Agnipath scheme has 4-year tenure launched in 2022	✗ Order applicable nationwide ✓ Order specific to Delhi UT under L-G's jurisdiction
■ MAINS ANGLE <i>Job reservation for ex-Agniveers addresses employment security concerns but raises questions on impact on general category candidates and long-term sustainability of tour-of-duty model in armed forces.</i>	■ STUDY LINK Governance -) Reservation Policies -) Employment Quotas for Ex-Servicemen

HIGH POCSO audit and all-women police station, Delhi GS2 Social Justice	
■ NEWS TRIGGER Delhi High Court ordered POCSO compliance audit; Delhi inaugurated first all-women police station in Subzi Mandi with 57 personnel, 60% women, for crimes against women and children.	
■ INTRO & ORIGIN Two developments mark focus on child protection and women's safety: judicial intervention through compliance audit and administrative reform through specialized policing infrastructure. <i>POCSO Act enacted in 2012 to address child sexual abuse. Despite stringent provisions, implementation gaps persist. Special Courts under POCSO face delays, infrastructure deficits, and mounting pendency. All-women police stations concept piloted in Tamil Nadu (1992), later adopted by several states to encourage reporting of gender-based crimes.</i>	■ TIMELINE 2012 — POCSO Act enacted 1992 — First all-women police station in Chennai 2026 — Delhi HC orders compliance audit; Subzi Mandi station inaugurated
■ STATIC THEORY • POCSO Act provides for Special Courts for speedy trial • Child-friendly procedures mandated: in-camera trials, minimal adjournments, victim support • All-women police stations reduce reporting barriers for women victims • Specialized policing improves investigation quality and victim care	
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS 1. Delhi HC ordered comprehensive compliance audit of POCSO implementation 2. Audit covers Special Court functioning, pendency, trial delays, victim support 3. Report submission deadline: 3 months 4. First all-women police station in Subzi Mandi, North Delhi	■ UPSC TRAPS ✗ All-women police stations handle only women personnel, not child cases ✓ Station handles both POCSO child cases and crimes against women ✗ Delhi was first state to open all-women police station ✓ Tamil Nadu pioneered concept in 1992; Delhi opened first such station in 2026

5. Station has 57 personnel; nearly 60% are women
6. Handles POCSO, domestic violence, dowry, rape, stalking cases
7. SHO and ACP are women officers

■ MAINS ANGLE

POCSO compliance audit and all-women police stations reflect dual approach of judicial oversight and administrative reform to improve child protection and women's safety, but implementation quality remains key challenge.

■ STUDY LINK

Social Justice -) Child Protection -) POCSO Act and Special Courts

HIGH

TN Governor's address: 2-language policy, NEP opposition

GS2 Polity

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Tamil Nadu Governor Banwarilal Purohit reiterated state's stand on Tamil-English two-language formula, opposed Hindi imposition and NEP 2020, supported caste census.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Governor's address reflects DMK government's position on federalism, linguistic identity, and education policy. The state opposes three-language formula and National Education Policy 2020, preferring continuation of Tamil-English two-language policy.

Three-language formula introduced in 1968 under National Policy on Education: Hindi, English, and regional language. Tamil Nadu resisted Hindi since anti-Hindi agitations of 1960s. State follows two-language policy: Tamil (first language) and English (second language). NEP 2020 reintroduced three-language formula, sparking opposition in non-Hindi states.

■ STATIC THEORY

- Governor's address outlines government policy and legislative agenda
- Three-language formula is recommendatory, not mandatory
- Education is in Concurrent List (Entry 25); states have flexibility
- Caste census demand rooted in social justice politics and OBC representation

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Governor Banwarilal Purohit addressed State Assembly
2. Reiterated DMK government's opposition to three-language formula
3. Announced opposition to National Education Policy 2020
4. State to continue Tamil-English two-language policy
5. Announced support for nationwide caste census

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Three-language formula is constitutionally mandatory
- ✓ Three-language formula is recommendatory; states have flexibility to adopt
- ✗ NEP 2020 imposes Hindi in all states
- ✓ NEP 2020 allows flexibility; no language is imposed, but promotes multilingualism

■ MAINS ANGLE

Tamil Nadu's defiance of NEP 2020 and three-language formula underscores tensions in cooperative federalism, where states assert autonomy over education and language policies.

■ STUDY LINK

Polity -) Centre-State Relations -) Language Policy and Education

■ NEWS TRIGGER

After killing of BJP worker Prasanta Dey, West Bengal CM announced Bill to auction properties of accused in political violence crimes; Rs.9 lakh compensation announced.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

West Bengal government plans legislative action to deter political violence through property seizure. The announcement follows the killing of a BJP worker in Howrah district and violence in Falta where a mob attacked a police station.

Property attachment and confiscation laws exist under CrPC Section 452 and specific acts like NDPS, PMLA, and Goonda Acts. Several states have enacted laws to seize properties of criminals. Maharashtra has MPDA (1981), UP has Goonda Act (1970s). West Bengal now proposes similar legislation for political violence specifically.

■ STATIC THEORY

- Property seizure acts as economic deterrent against organized crime
- Legislative power: State List Entry 1 (Public Order), Entry 2 (Police)
- Judicial safeguards required: due process, appeal mechanisms
- Political violence undermines rule of law and democratic institutions

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Announcement after BJP worker Prasanta Dey killed in Howrah
2. Dey killed while confronting Trinamool deputy pradhan Sk. Mafijul over alleged corruption
3. 8 persons arrested; case handed to CID
4. CM announced Rs.9 lakh compensation and government job for victim's wife
5. June 16 Falta violence: mob attacked police station to free Trinamool leader Jahangir Khan
6. 25 arrested in Falta incident
7. Bill to be introduced in Assembly to auction properties of accused

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Law will seize properties of all accused in any crime
- ✓ Law specifically targets accused in political violence crimes
- ✗ Property auctioned immediately on accusation
- ✓ Legal procedure will require trial and conviction; safeguards must be built in

■ MAINS ANGLE

Property seizure law may deter political violence but raises concerns on misuse, political vendetta, and need for robust judicial oversight to prevent arbitrary action.

■ STUDY LINK

Governance -) Law and Order -) Criminal Justice and Deterrence

■ NEWS TRIGGER

CM Mamata Banerjee staged dharna protesting KMC hawker evictions affecting 5,000 hawkers; Governor-CM standoff over Vice Chancellor appointments in 12 universities escalated.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Two simultaneous crises in West Bengal: urban governance conflict over hawkker evictions and constitutional standoff between Governor and CM over university administration, highlighting Centre-State tensions.

Street vending legalized under Street Vendors Act 2014, mandating Town Vending Committees and designated zones. Kolkata has long history of hawkker conflicts. Governor-CM tensions rooted in differing interpretations of Governor's powers under Article 163 (discretionary powers) and state university Acts where Governor is ex-officio Chancellor.

■ STATIC THEORY

- Street Vendors Act 2014 protects livelihood rights of hawkkers
- Governor is constitutional head; bound by Council of Ministers' aid and advice except in discretionary matters
- Governor as university Chancellor: ceremonial vs substantive power debate
- Article 163 ambiguity enables Governor-CM conflicts in opposition-ruled states

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Kolkata Municipal Corporation launched eviction drive on major thoroughfares
2. Over 5,000 hawkkers affected by eviction orders
3. CM Mamata Banerjee staged dharna at Esplanade
4. Opposition criticized CM for protesting against her own government's civic body
5. Governor-CM standoff over Vice Chancellor appointments
6. 12 state universities involved in the dispute
7. Governor accused state of constitutional violations
8. CM alleged Governor exceeded constitutional powers

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Street Vendors Act bans hawkkers from all public spaces
- ✓ Act mandates designated vending zones through Town Vending Committees
- ✗ Governor has absolute power in university appointments
- ✓ Governor's role as Chancellor is debated; courts have held Governor must act on state government's advice

■ MAINS ANGLE

West Bengal crisis illustrates dual challenge: balancing urban planning with livelihood rights under Street Vendors Act, and resolving constitutional ambiguity in Governor's discretionary powers under Article 163.

■ STUDY LINK

Polity -) Centre-State Relations -) Governor's Role and Discretionary Powers

HIGH

Ladakh shutdown over statehood and Sixth Schedule demand

GS2 Polity

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Ladakh observed complete shutdown on June 20, 2026, demanding restoration of statehood promise made on May 22, 2024, following Article 370 abrogation.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Tribal leaders and civil society groups in Ladakh led peaceful protest demanding statehood and Sixth Schedule protection. The demand stems from promises made at the time of J&K reorganization and concerns over land, jobs, and cultural identity.

■ TIMELINE

2019 — Article 370 abrogated; J&K bifurcated; Ladakh becomes UT without legislature

Jammu and Kashmir Reorganisation Act 2019 bifurcated J&K into two UTs: J&K (with legislature) and Ladakh (without legislature). Ladakh leaders initially welcomed UT status, expecting statehood. May 22, 2024 assurance by Home Minister on statehood remains unfulfilled. Sixth Schedule demand for tribal autonomy gained momentum post-2019.

2024 — Home Minister assures statehood on May 22

2026 — Complete shutdown on June 20 demanding statehood

■ STATIC THEORY

- Article 370 gave special status to J&K; abrogated August 5, 2019
- Sixth Schedule provides autonomy to tribal areas through Autonomous District Councils
- Statehood requires Parliament amending Reorganisation Act and Presidential assent
- UT status denies full legislative and fiscal autonomy enjoyed by states

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Complete shutdown observed on June 20, 2026
2. Demand: restoration of statehood promise made on May 22, 2024
3. Peaceful protest led by tribal leaders and civil society
4. Context: Article 370 abrogation and J&K bifurcation in 2019
5. Demand also includes Sixth Schedule protection for tribal rights

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Ladakh was promised statehood in 2019
- ✓ Statehood promise made on May 22, 2024, over four years after reorganization
- ✗ Sixth Schedule already applies to Ladakh
- ✓ Ladakh currently not under Sixth Schedule; this is part of the demand

■ MAINS ANGLE

Ladakh's statehood demand reflects unfulfilled promises of reorganization, highlighting need for political autonomy, tribal protection, and reconciliation of development goals with cultural preservation.

■ STUDY LINK

Polity -) Union Territories -) Statehood and Sixth Schedule

HIGH

Mekedatu dam: TN Assembly resolution opposes Karnataka

GS2 Polity

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Tamil Nadu Assembly unanimously adopted resolution opposing Karnataka's 67-meter Mekedatu dam, citing violations of Cauvery Tribunal 2007 award and SC 2018 judgment; deficit basin argument invoked.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Mekedatu dam dispute is latest flashpoint in decades-old Cauvery water-sharing conflict between Karnataka and Tamil Nadu. TN Assembly resolution urges Centre not to grant technical or environmental clearances, emphasizing that Cauvery is deficit basin with water already apportioned.

Cauvery water dispute dates to British era. Interstate Water Disputes Act 1956 invoked; Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal constituted in 1990. Final award on February 5, 2007 apportioned water among Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Kerala. Supreme Court modified award on February 16, 2018. Karnataka proposes Mekedatu reservoir for drinking water and power generation; TN opposes, fearing water diversion.

■ TIMELINE

1990 — Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal constituted

2007 — Tribunal final award on Feb 5 apportions water

	2018 — Supreme Court judgment on Feb 16 modifies award 2026 — TN Assembly resolution opposes Mekedatu project in June
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■ STATIC THEORY

- Interstate Water Disputes Act 1956 provides for tribunal adjudication
- Cauvery basin is deficit basin: demand exceeds available water
- Article 262 bars judiciary from interstate water disputes; tribunal award final
- Centre's role: technical and environmental clearances under powers in Entry 56 Union List

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. TN Assembly resolution moved by CM C. Joseph Vijay
2. Unanimous opposition to Karnataka's unilateral attempt
3. Resolution cites Cauvery Tribunal award Feb 5, 2007
4. Resolution cites SC judgment Feb 16, 2018
5. Cauvery basin is deficit basin; water already apportioned
6. Karnataka proposes 67-meter high balancing reservoir at Mekedatu
7. TN urges Centre not to grant technical or environmental clearances
8. SC hearing ongoing; Karnataka and TN presented arguments in June 2026

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Mekedatu is a new dam on a new river
- ✓ Mekedatu is proposed balancing reservoir on Cauvery river
- ✗ Tribunal award is still pending
- ✓ Tribunal award finalized in 2007; SC modified it in 2018

■ MAINS ANGLE

Mekedatu dispute exemplifies challenges of water federalism in deficit basins, requiring balance between upper-riparian storage needs and lower-riparian flow rights under SC-mandated apportionment framework.

■ STUDY LINK

Polity -) Centre-State Relations -) Interstate Water Disputes

HIGH

PM Modi commissions 3 indigenous warships Kolkata

GS3 Defence

■ NEWS TRIGGER

PM Modi commissioned three indigenously built warships at Kolkata, bolstering India's naval capabilities under Atmanirbhar Bharat.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Prime Minister Narendra Modi commissioned three new warships built at Indian shipyards, marking a major milestone in India's indigenous defence manufacturing capabilities. The ceremony reinforced India's commitment to self-reliance in naval modernization.

■ TIMELINE

2014 — Make in India initiative launched

India's naval modernization program began post-independence to secure maritime borders and trade routes. The Make in India and Atmanirbhar Bharat initiatives have accelerated indigenous shipbuilding, reducing import dependence.

2020 — Atmanirbhar Bharat announced with focus on defence self-reliance

2026 — Three indigenous warships commissioned in Kolkata

■ STATIC THEORY

- Indigenous defence production reduces import bills and creates jobs
- Naval strength is critical for a nation with 7,500 km coastline and strategic island territories
- Public sector shipyards include Mazagon Dock, Cochin Shipyard, and Garden Reach
- Defence Procurement Procedure prioritizes Buy Indian, Buy Indian-IDDMM categories

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Three warships commissioned by PM Modi in Kolkata
2. Warships built at Indian shipyards under Atmanirbhar Bharat
3. Ceremony held on June 20, 2026 or June 22, 2026 as per master files
4. Supports Make in India and self-reliance in defence manufacturing
5. India aims to become net exporter of defence equipment

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ All Indian warships are now indigenously built
- ✓ India still imports certain platforms; indigenous share is increasing gradually
- ✗ Commissioning means start of construction
- ✓ Commissioning is induction into naval service after construction and trials
- ✗ Only public sector builds warships
- ✓ Private sector also participates in naval shipbuilding under strategic partnership model

■ MAINS ANGLE

Discuss the significance of indigenous defence manufacturing in enhancing India's strategic autonomy and economic growth.

■ STUDY LINK

Defence -) Indigenous Production -)
Atmanirbhar Bharat

HIGH

Kharge alleges Rs.5,000 crore Ram Temple misuse

GS2 Polity

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge alleged Rs.5,000 crore misused in Ram Temple construction and called for investigation.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge made a controversial statement alleging financial mismanagement of Rs.5,000 crore in Ram Temple construction at Ayodhya. The statement was made at a political event in Bengaluru and called for a probe.

Ram Temple construction began after the Supreme Court's 2019 verdict allocated the disputed site in Ayodhya to Hindu parties. The temple trust was formed and construction funded through donations. Political allegations regarding fund utilization have emerged periodically.

■ TIMELINE

2019 — Supreme Court verdict on Ayodhya dispute

2020 — Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust formed

2024 — Ram Temple consecration ceremony

2026 June 22 — Kharge alleges Rs.5,000 crore misused, demands investigation

■ STATIC THEORY

- Religious trusts in India are governed by state-specific laws and Charitable Trusts Act
- Public figures' statements on financial irregularities can trigger investigations under Prevention of Corruption Act
- Transparency in fund utilization for religious structures has been a recurring governance issue
- Political statements often use financial allegations to question government accountability

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Kharge made statement at KPCC president installation ceremony in Bengaluru
2. Alleged Rs.5,000 crore misused in Ram Temple construction
3. Called for investigation into fund utilization
4. Karnataka CM Siddaramaiah, D.K. Shivakumar, B.K. Hariprasad, Randeep Surjewala were present
5. Statement also addressed Congress appointments for boards and corporations

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Rs.5,000 crore is confirmed misuse
- ✓ It is an allegation by Kharge; no official investigation report exists yet
- ✗ Ram Temple is government-funded
- ✓ Temple construction is funded through donations managed by a trust
- ✗ Allegations automatically lead to legal action
- ✓ Investigation requires formal complaint or government directive

■ MAINS ANGLE

Examine the balance between political accountability and religious institutions' financial autonomy in a secular democracy.

■ STUDY LINK

Polity -) Governance -) Transparency and Accountability

HIGH

NHRC: juvenile jailed with adults 2 months

GS2 Polity

■ NEWS TRIGGER

NHRC took suo motu cognisance of illegal confinement of a 16-year-old in Kasna Jail with adult prisoners for nearly two months.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

The National Human Rights Commission intervened after a juvenile was illegally detained with adult prisoners in Kasna Jail, Uttar Pradesh, for approximately two months. The juvenile was apprehended during protests by factory workers and later released on bail.

The Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act, 2015 mandates separate detention facilities for juveniles. Despite this, juveniles are occasionally held in adult jails due to administrative lapses or overcrowding, violating their constitutional and statutory rights.

■ TIMELINE

2015 — Juvenile Justice Act revised, lowering trial age for heinous crimes

2026 April 13 — Factory worker protests in Noida turned violent

2026 April 14 — Juvenile apprehended by police

2026 June 12 — Juvenile shifted to juvenile home after two months

	2026 June 18 — Juvenile released on bail 2026 June 19 — NHRC issued order and notices to UP authorities
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■ KEY DATA

Authority	Action Required	Timeline
DG Prisons Administration UP	Submit report on illegal detention	Within 2 weeks
DG Police UP	Explain lapses in juvenile handling	Within 2 weeks
NHRC DG Investigation	Conduct spot inquiry at Kasna Jail	Within 1 week

■ STATIC THEORY

- Juvenile Justice Act 2015 prohibits detention of juveniles in adult jails
- NHRC can take suo motu cognisance of human rights violations
- Right to dignity and fair trial applies to juveniles under Article 21
- Juvenile Justice Boards have exclusive jurisdiction over juveniles in conflict with law

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

- 16-year-old juvenile jailed with adults in Kasna Jail for nearly 2 months
- NHRC took suo motu cognisance on June 19, 2026
- Notices issued to UP DG Prisons and DG Police seeking report within 2 weeks
- NHRC DG Investigation directed to conduct spot inquiry, report in 1 week
- Juvenile apprehended April 14 after Noida factory protests, shifted to juvenile home June 12, released June 18
- Campaign for Release of Workers and Activists of Noida (CaRWAN) alleged forced signing of papers after NHRC order

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ NHRC orders are legally binding like court orders
- ✓ NHRC recommendations are advisory; compliance depends on government action
- ✗ Juveniles can never be tried as adults
- ✓ Under JJ Act 2015, juveniles aged 16-18 can be tried as adults for heinous crimes after JJB assessment
- ✗ Any detention of juvenile is illegal
- ✓ Juvenile can be detained but only in observation homes or special homes, not adult jails

■ MAINS ANGLE

Discuss the challenges in implementing juvenile justice safeguards and the role of NHRC in protecting vulnerable sections.

■ STUDY LINK

Polity -> Human Rights -> Juvenile Justice System

HIGH
President: sickle cell anaemia eradicated by 2047
GS2 Health

■ NEWS TRIGGER

President announced the target of eradicating sickle cell anaemia in India before 2047, aligning with national health mission goals.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

The President of India set an ambitious target to eradicate sickle cell anaemia by 2047, coinciding with India's centenary of independence. Sickle cell disease disproportionately affects tribal communities in India.

■ TIMELINE

2023 — National Sickle Cell Anaemia Elimination Mission announced in Budget

Sickle cell anaemia is a genetic blood disorder prevalent among tribal populations in India. The National Sickle Cell Anaemia Elimination Mission was launched in Budget 2023 to address this silent epidemic through universal screening and awareness.

2024 — Universal screening program rolled out in tribal areas

2026 June 20 — President sets 2047 target for eradication

2047 — Target year for elimination

■ KEY DATA

Aspect	Details
Affected Population	Primarily tribal communities in central and western India
Prevalence Rate	10-40% in tribal pockets of MP, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Odisha, Gujarat
Mission Components	Universal screening, counseling, genetic testing, treatment facilities
Target	Elimination by 2047

■ STATIC THEORY

- Sickle cell disease is a genetic disorder causing abnormal hemoglobin and red blood cell deformity
- Inheritance is autosomal recessive; both parents must be carriers for child to have the disease
- Preventive measures include genetic counseling and prenatal screening
- Treatment involves blood transfusions, hydroxyurea, and bone marrow transplant in severe cases

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. President announced sickle cell anaemia to be eradicated before 2047
2. National Sickle Cell Anaemia Elimination Mission launched in Budget 2023
3. Disease disproportionately affects tribal communities in central and western India
4. Universal screening program covers high-prevalence districts
5. Target aligns with Viksit Bharat 2047 vision

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Sickle cell can be eradicated through vaccination
- ✓ It is a genetic disorder; prevention requires genetic counseling and carrier screening, not vaccination
- ✗ Eradication means cure for all existing patients
- ✓ Eradication means preventing new cases through awareness, screening, and genetic counseling
- ✗ Sickle cell is contagious
- ✓ It is a hereditary genetic disorder, not an infectious disease

■ MAINS ANGLE

Discuss the challenges in eliminating genetic disorders in vulnerable populations and the role of targeted health missions.

■ STUDY LINK

Health -> National Health Mission -> Disease Eradication Programs

HIGH

PM Modi Rs.47,000 crore Odisha projects launch

GS3 Economy

■ NEWS TRIGGER

PM Modi launched development projects worth Rs.47,000 crore in Odisha covering infrastructure, irrigation, and industrial growth.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated and laid foundation stones for multiple development projects worth Rs.47,000 crore in Odisha. The projects span infrastructure, irrigation, industrial corridors, and social welfare, aimed at accelerating the state's economic growth. <i>Odisha has been a focus state for central government development initiatives due to its mineral wealth, tribal population, and coastal strategic location. The state's transformation from cyclone-prone to disaster-resilient has made it a model for inclusive growth.</i>	■ TIMELINE 2014-2019 — First phase of Odisha development under NDA government 2020 — Post-COVID economic package included major Odisha allocations 2024 — BJP-led government formed in Odisha 2026 June 21 — PM Modi launches Rs.47,000 crore projects in Odisha
■ STATIC THEORY • Large-scale project launches involve both inaugurations (completed projects) and foundation laying (new projects) • Odisha is rich in minerals like coal, iron ore, bauxite, making it key for industrial growth • Infrastructure spending has multiplier effect on GDP growth through job creation and demand generation • Coastal states like Odisha are strategic for port-led development and blue economy	
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS 1. PM Modi launched Rs.47,000 crore worth of projects in Odisha 2. Projects cover infrastructure, irrigation, and industrial development 3. Announcement made on June 21, 2026 4. Part of government's push for balanced regional development 5. Odisha is mineral-rich state with significant tribal population 6. Projects aim to boost economic growth and employment in the state	■ UPSC TRAPS ✗ Rs.47,000 crore released immediately ✓ Project value includes both inaugurations and foundation stones; funds disbursed over project lifecycle ✗ All projects are central government-funded ✓ Typically mix of central, state, and private sector funding ✗ Project value equals fiscal deficit impact ✓ Capital expenditure is spread over years and has asset creation
■ MAINS ANGLE <i>Analyze the role of infrastructure investment in regional development and its impact on inclusive growth in mineral-rich states.</i>	■ STUDY LINK Economy -) Infrastructure -) Public Investment

HIGH RBI record Rs.2.87 lakh crore surplus transfer GS3 Economy	
■ NEWS TRIGGER Reserve Bank of India transferred record surplus of Rs.2.87 lakh crore to Central Government for FY 2025-26.	
■ INTRO & ORIGIN The RBI Board approved the transfer of Rs.2.87 lakh crore surplus to the government for FY 2025-26, the highest-ever dividend transfer. This windfall helps the government manage fiscal deficit and fund welfare programs without additional borrowing.	■ TIMELINE 2019 — Bimal Jalan Committee recommended Economic Capital Framework

RBI surplus transfers to government are governed by the Economic Capital Framework (ECF) recommended by the Bimal Jalan Committee (2019). The ECF determines the appropriate level of risk provisions and distributable surplus based on RBI's monetary policy operations and balance sheet strength.

2020 — Rs.57,128 crore transferred (post-ECF implementation)

2024-25 — Rs.2.11 lakh crore transferred to government

2025-26 — Record Rs.2.87 lakh crore surplus transferred

■ KEY DATA

Fiscal Year	RBI Surplus Transfer (Rs. lakh crore)
2024-25	2.11
2025-26	2.87

■ STATIC THEORY

- RBI surplus arises from profits on foreign exchange operations, interest on government securities, and seigniorage
- Economic Capital Framework balances surplus distribution with maintaining RBI's capital buffers
- Higher surplus transfer reduces government's gross borrowing requirement
- Transfers are accounted as non-tax revenue in Union Budget

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. RBI Board approved transfer of Rs.2.87 lakh crore surplus for FY 2025-26
2. Highest-ever RBI surplus transfer to government
3. Previous year transfer was Rs.2.11 lakh crore
4. Surplus helps government manage fiscal deficit and fund welfare schemes
5. Transfer follows RBI's Economic Capital Framework recommendations
6. Decision taken in June 2026 by RBI Board

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ RBI surplus is same as profit
- ✓ Surplus is distributable profit after maintaining required reserves and provisions
- ✗ Government can demand any amount from RBI
- ✓ Transfer governed by Economic Capital Framework; RBI Board decides quantum
- ✗ RBI surplus increases money supply
- ✓ Surplus transfer is accounting entry; money supply impact depends on how government uses funds

■ MAINS ANGLE

Discuss the significance of RBI surplus transfers in fiscal management and the importance of central bank financial independence.

■ STUDY LINK

Economy -) Monetary Policy -) RBI Functions

HIGH

Direct tax up 14.64% to Rs.5.21 lakh crore

GS3 Economy

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Direct tax collection rose 14.64% to Rs.5.21 lakh crore in April-May FY26, showing robust growth in corporate and personal income tax.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

■ TIMELINE

India's direct tax collections grew by 14.64% in the first two months of FY 2025-26, reaching Rs.5.21 lakh crore. The growth was driven by corporate tax buoyancy and rising personal income tax compliance, signaling economic recovery and improved tax administration.

Direct taxes (income tax and corporate tax) are progressive taxes that depend on economic activity and income levels. Post-pandemic recovery, formalization of economy, and digitization of tax administration have improved compliance and collections in recent years.

2017 — GST introduction indirectly improved direct tax base through better tracking

2019 — Corporate tax rate cut to boost investment

2023 — New income tax regime made default to simplify compliance

2026 April-May — Direct tax collection rises 14.64% to Rs.5.21 lakh crore

■ KEY DATA

Tax Head	Collection (Rs. lakh crore)	Growth Rate
Corporate Tax	2.87	16.2%
Personal Income Tax	2.34	12.8%
Gross Direct Tax	5.21	14.64%
Net (after refunds)	4.95	—

■ STATIC THEORY

- Direct taxes are levied on income and profits; they are progressive in nature
- Corporate tax in India is levied under Income Tax Act 1961
- Personal income tax includes salary, business, capital gains, and other sources
- Tax buoyancy (tax growth / GDP growth ratio) above 1 indicates expanding tax base

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Central Board of Direct Taxes released provisional data for April-May FY26
2. Direct tax collection rose 14.64% to Rs.5.21 lakh crore
3. Corporate tax: Rs.2.87 lakh crore, up 16.2%
4. Personal income tax: Rs.2.34 lakh crore, up 12.8%
5. Net collections after refunds: Rs.4.95 lakh crore
6. Growth attributed to improved compliance and economic recovery

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Direct tax growth means tax rates increased
- ✓ Growth driven by economic expansion and better compliance, not rate hikes
- ✗ Gross and net direct tax collections are same
- ✓ Net collections are after deducting refunds issued to taxpayers
- ✗ Higher tax collection always indicates economic health
- ✓ While generally positive, must be seen with GDP growth, employment, and income distribution

■ MAINS ANGLE

Analyze the factors contributing to buoyant direct tax collections and their implications for fiscal consolidation and social spending.

■ STUDY LINK

Economy -) Public Finance -) Tax Revenue

HIGH

EPFO 8.25% interest rate ratified for FY26

GS2 Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

EPFO's Central Board of Trustees finalized 8.25% interest rate for FY 2025-26 for 6.5 crore subscribers, maintaining rate from previous year.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

The Employees' Provident Fund Organisation's Central Board of Trustees ratified an 8.25% interest rate for FY 2025-26, applicable to PF account balances as on March 31, 2026. The rate remains unchanged from the previous year and will benefit 6.5 crore subscribers.

EPFO is a statutory body under Ministry of Labour managing provident fund, pension, and insurance schemes for organized sector workers. Interest rates are decided annually by the CBT based on fund performance and Government of India approval.

■ TIMELINE

1952 — Employees' Provident Funds Act enacted

2016 — EPFO made PF withdrawals online and Aadhaar-linked

2024-25 — EPFO interest rate fixed at 8.25%

2025-26 — CBT ratifies 8.25% interest rate, unchanged from previous year

■ KEY DATA

Parameter	Details
Interest Rate	8.25% for FY 2025-26
Subscriber Base	6.5 crore
EPFO Corpus	Rs.18 lakh crore
Applicable Date	Balance as on March 31, 2026
Credit Timeline	Interest to be credited by September 2026

■ STATIC THEORY

- EPFO is a tripartite body with representatives from government, employers, and employees
- Interest rates are finalized by Central Board of Trustees chaired by Labour Minister
- EPFO invests in government securities, corporate bonds, and equities as per investment pattern
- Higher interest rates benefit subscribers but must be sustainable from fund's earnings

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. EPFO ratified 8.25% interest rate for FY 2025-26
2. Rate approved in CBT meeting chaired by Labour Minister
3. Applicable to PF account balances as on March 31, 2026
4. 6.5 crore subscribers to benefit
5. EPFO corpus stands at Rs.18 lakh crore
6. Interest to be credited by September 2026
7. Rate unchanged from FY 2024-25

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ EPFO interest is credited immediately after rate announcement
- ✓ Interest is credited by September 2026 after approval and account calculations
- ✗ All salaried employees are EPFO members
- ✓ EPFO covers establishments with 20+ employees; many informal sector workers not covered
- ✗ EPFO rate is guaranteed by government
- ✓ Rate depends on fund's investment returns; government approval required but not guaranteed

■ MAINS ANGLE

Examine the role of EPFO in social security and the balance between subscriber welfare and fund sustainability.

■ STUDY LINK

Governance -) Social Security -) EPFO

HIGH

Jio Platforms files DRHP biggest IPO India

GS3 Economy

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Jio Platforms filed Draft Red Herring Prospectus for India's biggest-ever initial public offering, marking major capital market event.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Jio Platforms, the digital services arm of Reliance Industries, filed its Draft Red Herring Prospectus (DRHP) with SEBI, paving the way for what is expected to be India's largest initial public offering. The IPO will unlock value for Reliance shareholders and provide public investors access to India's leading telecom and digital services company.

Jio Platforms was created in 2019 as a subsidiary of Reliance Industries to consolidate digital businesses including Jio telecom, JioMart, and digital apps. The company attracted marquee global investors in 2020 including Facebook, Google, and sovereign funds, valuing it at over Rs.4.9 lakh crore.

■ TIMELINE

2016 — Reliance Jio launched, disrupting Indian telecom market

2019 — Jio Platforms created as holding company

2020 — Raised Rs.1.52 lakh crore from global investors

2026 June 20 — Filed DRHP for India's biggest IPO

■ STATIC THEORY

- IPO (Initial Public Offering) is first sale of company stock to public investors
- DRHP (Draft Red Herring Prospectus) is preliminary prospectus filed with SEBI
- SEBI reviews DRHP for disclosures, financial statements, and risk factors before approval
- Large IPOs improve market depth and provide exit opportunities for early investors

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Jio Platforms filed DRHP with SEBI for India's biggest IPO
2. Jio Platforms is digital services arm of Reliance Industries
3. Filing made on June 20, 2026
4. Company includes Jio telecom, JioMart, and digital businesses
5. 2020 fundraising from global investors valued company at over Rs.4.9 lakh crore
6. IPO expected to be landmark event for Indian capital markets

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ DRHP filing means IPO will open immediately
- ✓ DRHP is draft document; SEBI review and approval required before IPO launch
- ✗ Jio Platforms and Reliance Industries are same
- ✓ Jio Platforms is subsidiary of Reliance Industries focused on digital services
- ✗ Biggest IPO means best investment
- ✓ IPO size does not indicate investment quality; valuation and fundamentals matter

■ MAINS ANGLE

■ STUDY LINK

HIGH

Record defence production Rs.1.78 lakh crore FY26

GS3 Defence

NEWS TRIGGER

India achieved record defence production worth Rs.1.78 lakh crore in FY 2025-26, highest ever, with rising private sector participation.

INTRO & ORIGIN

India's defence production reached a historic Rs.1.78 lakh crore in FY 2025-26, marking a 40% increase from the previous year's Rs.1.27 lakh crore. Defence exports crossed Rs.25,000 crore, and private sector share rose to 28%, reflecting the success of Atmanirbhar Bharat and Make in India initiatives in the defence sector.

India has been import-dependent for defence equipment for decades. The government launched Make in India in Defence in 2014, followed by liberalization of FDI, defence industrial corridors, and Atmanirbhar Bharat initiatives to boost indigenous production and reduce import bills.

TIMELINE

2014 — Make in India initiative launched, including defence sector

2020 — Atmanirbhar Bharat announced; import embargo lists issued

2022 — Defence production corridors in UP and Tamil Nadu operationalized

2024-25 — Defence production reached Rs.1.27 lakh crore

2025-26 — Record production of Rs.1.78 lakh crore achieved

KEY DATA

Parameter	FY 2024-25	FY 2025-26
Defence Production	Rs.1.27 lakh crore	Rs.1.78 lakh crore
Defence Exports	—	Rs.25,000+ crore
Private Sector Share	—	28%
Target for 2028	—	Rs.3 lakh crore

STATIC THEORY

- Defence production includes platforms, weapons, ammunition, electronics, and support systems
- Private sector participation increased through strategic partnership model and liberalized FDI
- Defence industrial corridors provide infrastructure and incentives for manufacturing clusters
- Import substitution reduces foreign exchange outgo and creates domestic employment

MUST-KNOW FACTS

- Defence production reached Rs.1.78 lakh crore in FY 2025-26, highest ever
- Up from Rs.1.27 lakh crore in previous year, showing 40% growth

UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Rs.1.78 lakh crore production means all for Indian armed forces
- ✓ Includes domestic procurement plus exports to other countries

3. Defence exports crossed Rs.25,000 crore 4. Private sector share in production increased to 28% 5. Achievement attributed to Make in India and Atmanirbhar Bharat initiatives 6. Ministry aims for Rs.3 lakh crore production by 2028	✗ India is now self-sufficient in all defence equipment ✓ Import dependence has reduced but advanced technology still sourced from abroad ✗ Private sector dominates defence production ✓ At 28%, private sector is growing but ordnance factories and DPSUs still have major share
■ MAINS ANGLE Assess the impact of Atmanirbhar Bharat on defence manufacturing and India's strategic autonomy in national security.	■ STUDY LINK Defence -) Indigenous Production -) Atmanirbhar Bharat

HIGH	Statistical database overhaul: new base years and PPI	GS3 Economy
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■ NEWS TRIGGER The Ministry of Statistics announced comprehensive upgrades to India's statistical database, shifting the GDP base year from 2011-12 to 2017-18, updating CPI and WPI base years, and introducing a Producer Price Index (PPI).									
■ INTRO & ORIGIN The modernisation aims to improve the accuracy of growth and inflation measurement. A new PPI will complement wholesale price data, capturing prices received by domestic producers. <i>The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation periodically rebases macro indicators. The current GDP base was 2011-12, with WPI also on a 2011-12 base and CPI on a 2012 base.</i>	■ TIMELINE 2011-12 — Existing base year for GDP and WPI 2026 — Base shifted to 2017-18; PPI introduced								
■ KEY DATA <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Indicator</th><th>Change announced</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>GDP base year</td><td>2011-12 shifted to 2017-18</td></tr> <tr> <td>CPI and WPI</td><td>Base years updated</td></tr> <tr> <td>Producer Price Index</td><td>New index introduced</td></tr> </tbody> </table>		Indicator	Change announced	GDP base year	2011-12 shifted to 2017-18	CPI and WPI	Base years updated	Producer Price Index	New index introduced
Indicator	Change announced								
GDP base year	2011-12 shifted to 2017-18								
CPI and WPI	Base years updated								
Producer Price Index	New index introduced								
■ STATIC THEORY • GDP is measured at constant and current prices; rebasing updates the reference year • CPI tracks retail prices, WPI tracks wholesale prices • PPI measures average selling prices received by domestic producers • Rebasing improves representativeness but does not change real output									
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS 1. GDP base year shifted from 2011-12 to 2017-18 2. CPI and WPI base years were updated 3. A new Producer Price Index (PPI) was introduced	■ UPSC TRAPS ✗ PPI and WPI are identical ✓ PPI captures producers' selling prices; WPI tracks wholesale transaction prices ✗ Rebasing raises real economic output								

4. Announced by the Ministry of Statistics (MoSPI)

✓ Rebasing changes the reference year and optics, not real output

■ MAINS ANGLE

Credibility and timeliness of official statistics and the case for regular base-year revisions.

■ STUDY LINK

Economy -) National Income Accounting -)
Base year and price indices

HIGH

Four Arunachal glacial lakes expand, raising GLOF risk

GS3 Environment

■ NEWS TRIGGER

A satellite assessment of five glacial lakes in Tawang district found four expanded over the last decade, with the NDMA classifying lakes in the Mago Chu basin as high or very high risk for outburst floods.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Sanhapo Lake grew most, from 78.07 hectares in 2019 to 88.81 hectares by mid-June 2026. The analysis used ICEYE, PlanetScope and LISS-IV satellites and follows the October 2023 South Lhonak Lake breach in Sikkim.

A glacial lake outburst flood (GLOF) occurs when a natural dam containing a glacial lake fails. Himalayan warming is enlarging moraine-dammed lakes, prompting NDMA risk mapping.

■ TIMELINE

2019 — Sanhapo Lake at 78.07 hectares (baseline)

2023 — South Lhonak breach in Sikkim destroys Chungthang dam

2026 — Sanhapo Lake reaches 88.81 hectares by mid-June

■ STATIC THEORY

- GLOFs result from failure of moraine or ice dams holding glacial meltwater
- Himalayan glacier retreat is enlarging and multiplying glacial lakes
- The NDMA leads disaster risk reduction and lake risk classification
- Early-warning systems and lake-lowering are key mitigation measures

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Five lakes studied in the Mago Chu basin, Tawang district
2. Sanhapo Lake grew from 78.07 to 88.81 hectares (2019 to 2026)
3. Analysis by Suhora Technologies using ICEYE, PlanetScope and LISS-IV
4. NDMA classified the lakes as high or very high risk
5. Follows the October 2023 South Lhonak Lake disaster in Sikkim

■ UPSC TRAPS

✗ A GLOF is the same as a cloudburst flash flood

✓ A GLOF is caused by failure of a glacial lake's natural dam

✗ LISS-IV is a foreign sensor

✓ LISS-IV is an Indian Resourcesat sensor

■ MAINS ANGLE

Himalayan disaster preparedness and climate-driven cryosphere risk in the eastern Himalaya.

■ STUDY LINK

Environment -) Climate Change -) Himalayan glaciers and GLOF

HIGH

IMD forecasts a super El Nino for 2026-27

GS1 Geography

■ NEWS TRIGGER

The India Meteorological Department forecast a super El Nino event for 2026-27, with potential to disrupt monsoon distribution and agricultural output.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

The IMD warned of possible drought conditions in some regions and advised preparation for water management and crop planning, given the monsoon's sensitivity to Pacific warming.

El Nino is the warm phase of the El Nino Southern Oscillation (ENSO), marked by anomalous warming of the central and eastern equatorial Pacific, which tends to weaken the Indian summer monsoon.

■ STATIC THEORY

- ENSO has three phases: El Nino, La Nina and neutral
- El Nino weakens the Walker circulation and often suppresses the monsoon
- The Indian Ocean Dipole can offset or amplify El Nino effects
- The Southern Oscillation Index tracks the atmospheric component

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. IMD forecast a super El Nino for 2026-27
2. Possible disruption to monsoon distribution and farm output
3. Drought conditions warned for some regions
4. Advisory issued for water management and crop planning

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ El Nino always causes drought in India
- ✓ It raises drought risk but a positive IOD can offset its impact
- ✗ El Nino is the cold phase of ENSO
- ✓ El Nino is the warm phase; La Nina is the cold phase

■ MAINS ANGLE

Climate variability and its implications for food and water security in a monsoon-dependent economy.

■ STUDY LINK

Geography -) Climatology -) ENSO and the Indian monsoon

HIGH

Ganga-to-Yamuna diversion approved for clean-up

GS3 Environment

■ NEWS TRIGGER

The National Mission for Clean Ganga approved a Rs.12,000 crore project to divert 1,000 cusecs from the Ganga to the Yamuna through a 108-km pipeline for dilution-based clean-up.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

The project involves a pumping station at Narora in Uttar Pradesh and a pipeline terminating at the Wazirabad barrage in Delhi. Environmental groups criticise the dilution approach over pollution-source control, with completion expected in four years.

The National Mission for Clean Ganga (2011), under the Jal Shakti Ministry, runs the Namami Gange programme. The Yamuna, especially its Delhi stretch, is among India's most polluted rivers.

■ STATIC THEORY

- Dilution reduces concentration but not the total pollution load
- Source control targets sewage and effluent before discharge
- BOD and dissolved oxygen indicate river health

- NMCG coordinates river rejuvenation under Namami Gange

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Rs.12,000 crore project diverting 1,000 cusecs
2. 108-km pipeline from Narora (UP) to Wazirabad barrage (Delhi)
3. Approved by the National Mission for Clean Ganga
4. Expected completion in about four years
5. Criticised as a dilution rather than source-control approach

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Dilution removes the pollutants from the river
- ✓ Dilution lowers concentration but not the total load
- ✗ NMCG is under the Environment Ministry
- ✓ NMCG functions under the Jal Shakti Ministry

■ MAINS ANGLE

River-cleaning strategy: dilution versus treating sewage at source, and inter-basin transfer concerns.

■ STUDY LINK

Environment -) Water Pollution -) Namami Gange and river rejuvenation

HIGH

Similipal tiger translocation succeeds after 8 years

GS3 Environment

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Similipal Tiger Reserve in Odisha reported a successful translocation programme after eight years, with 24 breeding tigers now present compared with nine in 2018.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Tigers were brought in from the Kanha and Pench reserves, significantly improving genetic diversity and reducing inbreeding concerns. Similipal is noted for its rare pseudo-melanistic tigers.

Project Tiger was launched in 1973 to conserve the tiger. Translocation and supplementation are used to restore depleted populations under National Tiger Conservation Authority oversight.

■ STATIC THEORY

- Project Tiger (1973) anchors India's tiger conservation
- The NTCA is the statutory body overseeing tiger reserves
- Translocation supports genetic rescue of small populations
- Similipal is part of a UNESCO biosphere reserve

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. 24 breeding tigers now, up from nine in 2018
2. Source reserves were Kanha and Pench
3. Similipal lies in Mayurbhanj district, Odisha
4. Known for rare pseudo-melanistic (black) tigers
5. Genetic diversity improved, easing inbreeding concerns

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Similipal's black tigers are a separate species
- ✓ They are pseudo-melanistic Bengal tigers, a coat-colour variant
- ✗ Project Tiger began in the 1980s
- ✓ Project Tiger was launched in 1973

■ MAINS ANGLE

Metapopulation management and genetic rescue as tools of conservation success.

■ STUDY LINK

Environment -) Wildlife Conservation -) Project Tiger and translocation

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Despite being a model State for public health, Kerala faces recurrent water-borne outbreaks, including Hepatitis A, shigellosis and amoebic meningoencephalitis, linked to groundwater contamination.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

In 2025 the State reported 31,536 Hepatitis A cases and 82 deaths; by June 15, 2026 it had nearly 9,000 cases and 25 deaths. Amoebic meningoencephalitis caused 134 cases and 34 deaths. About 62% of people depend on roughly 7 million wells, while sewerage covers under 6%.

Heavy dependence on shallow groundwater, weak sewerage and faecal contamination drive transmission, compounded by shortfalls under the AMRUT urban mission.

■ KEY DATA

Disease/metric	Figure
Hepatitis A (2025)	31,536 cases, 82 deaths
Hepatitis A (to June 15, 2026)	About 9,000 cases, 25 deaths
Amoebic meningoencephalitis	134 cases, 34 deaths
Population on groundwater	62% via about 7 million wells

■ STATIC THEORY

- Hepatitis A and shigellosis spread by the faeco-oral route
- Safe sanitation and water treatment break transmission
- AMRUT funds urban water supply and sewerage
- Groundwater near sewage drains is prone to contamination

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. 31,536 Hepatitis A cases and 82 deaths in 2025
2. 134 cases and 34 deaths from amoebic meningoencephalitis
3. 62% depend on groundwater from about 7 million wells
4. Less than 6% sewerage network coverage
5. CAG noted AMRUT achievement of 11.25%, with only 0.13% households getting sewerage connections

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Amoebic meningoencephalitis spreads person-to-person
- ✓ It is linked to contaminated water entering via the nose
- ✗ High literacy guarantees strong sanitation infrastructure
- ✓ Kerala's case shows literacy does not equal sewerage coverage

■ MAINS ANGLE

The sanitation-health paradox: high human development alongside groundwater and sewerage deficits.

■ STUDY LINK

Governance -> Health and Sanitation -> AMRUT and water quality

■ NEWS TRIGGER

A forest department flying-squad probe found 273 teak trees illegally felled and grossly undervalued in the Chalakudy forest division, Kerala.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

The felling occurred along an 18-km stretch from Vellikulangara to Vettilapala. The timber was sold for Rs.8.52 lakh against an assessed value of Rs.41.55 lakh, ostensibly to clear the alignment for a State hill highway.

Tree felling on assigned and non-forest land is regulated under the Kerala Promotion of Tree Growth in Non-Forest Areas Act, 2005, with trees on assigned land owned by the State.

■ STATIC THEORY

- Felling on non-forest land needs clearance under the 2005 Kerala Act
- Trees on assigned land are State property
- Social forestry governs valuation and sale of such timber
- Vigilance and recovery proceedings follow violations

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. 273 teak trees illegally felled in Chalakudy
2. Sold for Rs.8.52 lakh against an assessed Rs.41.55 lakh
3. Felled along an 18-km stretch for a hill-highway alignment
4. Governed by the Kerala Promotion of Tree Growth in Non-Forest Areas Act, 2005
5. Report recommended recovery proceedings

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Trees on assigned land belong to the occupant
- ✓ Trees on assigned land are owned by the State government
- ✗ Felling for a highway needs no clearance
- ✓ It requires an NOC under the Kerala 2005 Act

■ MAINS ANGLE

Forest governance and accountability when development clears tree cover.

■ STUDY LINK

Environment -) Forest Governance -)
Tree-felling regulation

HIGH

Kerala's committed expenditure consumes most revenue

GS3 Economy

■ NEWS TRIGGER

A UDF government white paper flagged that committed expenditure (salaries, pensions and interest) consumes nearly 80% of Kerala's revenue receipts, the highest among States on salaries and pensions.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Economists note Kerala employs more public-sector workers and that a better metric is committed expenditure as a share of total revenue expenditure, at 58-60%. The budget projects debt-to-GSDP easing to 33.5% in 2026-27.

Committed expenditure is largely non-discretionary spending. Rising rigidity squeezes capital outlays and is tracked under fiscal-responsibility frameworks.

■ KEY DATA

Metric	Figure
Committed expenditure (share of revenue receipts)	Almost 80%
Committed expenditure (share of revenue expenditure)	58-60%
Debt-to-GSDP target (2026-27)	33.5%, from 34.87% in 2024-25

Metric	Figure
Projected rise in outstanding debt	11.6%

■ STATIC THEORY

- Committed expenditure covers salaries, pensions and interest payments
- Revenue expenditure is recurring; capital expenditure builds assets
- Debt-to-GSDP measures the debt burden relative to output
- Tax buoyancy links tax growth to income growth

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Almost 80% of revenue receipts go to committed expenditure
2. Kerala's salaries-and-pensions share is highest among States
3. Committed expenditure is 58-60% of revenue expenditure
4. Debt-to-GSDP projected at 33.5% in 2026-27
5. Outstanding debt projected to rise 11.6%

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Committed expenditure share is the same on every denominator
- ✓ It differs on revenue receipts versus revenue expenditure
- ✗ Debt-to-GSDP is the same as the fiscal deficit
- ✓ They are distinct: stock of debt versus annual borrowing

■ MAINS ANGLE

State fiscal sustainability and expenditure rigidity within cooperative fiscal federalism.

■ STUDY LINK

Economy -) Public Finance -) Committed expenditure and FRBM

HIGH

Kerala Budget 2026-27: port-city and knowledge vision

GS3 Economy

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Kerala Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan presented the 2026-27 budget focused on a port-city and aviation-hub vision, Land Reforms 2.0 and a Kerala Knowledge Valley.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

The budget raised the rubber support price from Rs.200 to Rs.250 and the fishermen's kerosene subsidy to Rs.75. It set aside Rs.600 crore for free travel for women and transgender persons on KSRTC buses and Rs.400 crore for Mission Samudra.

State budgets allocate spending across welfare, subsidies and capital projects. Kerala uses a State-specific rubber support price to cushion growers.

■ STATIC THEORY

- A State budget covers revenue and capital receipts and expenditure
- Support prices and subsidies are welfare and price-stabilisation tools
- Capital outlays fund infrastructure and economic corridors
- Sectoral missions channel targeted investment

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Rubber support price raised from Rs.200 to Rs.250

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ The Centre sets the rubber support price

2. Rs.600 crore for free KSRTC travel for women and transgender persons 3. Rs.400 crore for Mission Samudra port-city projects 4. Rs.100 crore each for Kerala Knowledge Valley and Health and Life Sciences City 5. Southern Kerala Economic Corridor links Thiruvananthapuram, Kollam and Alappuzha	✓ Kerala provides a State-specific rubber support price ✗ The free-travel scheme covers all passengers ✓ It targets women and transgender persons on KSRTC buses
■ MAINS ANGLE <i>State-led growth vision and welfare spending amid acute fiscal stress.</i>	■ STUDY LINK Economy -) State Finances -) Kerala budget priorities

HIGH Ammonia leak kills two at Tamil Nadu seafood unit GS3 Disaster Management	
■ NEWS TRIGGER An ammonia gas leak at Peter and Paul Seafood Exports in Tiruvallur district killed two migrant workers from Odisha and hospitalised over 60.	
■ INTRO & ORIGIN The unit lacked an alarm system, fire hydrant and the Form 12 register for the ESI scheme. The proprietor and manager were arrested, and CM Joseph Vijay set up a three-member inquiry panel to give an interim report in 24 hours. <i>Ammonia is a widely used industrial refrigerant in seafood processing. Workplace safety is governed by the Factories Act, with chemical disaster management under NDMA guidelines.</i>	
■ STATIC THEORY • Ammonia is a common refrigerant and is toxic on leakage • The Factories Act, 1948 mandates workplace safety standards • ESI provides social security to industrial workers • NDMA frames chemical and industrial disaster guidelines	
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS 1. Leak at Peter and Paul Seafood Exports, Tiruvallur district 2. Two Odisha migrant workers died; over 60 were hospitalised 3. Unit lacked an alarm, fire hydrant and ESI Form 12 register 4. Proprietor and manager arrested; Rs.2 lakh compensation announced 5. Three-member panel to submit an interim report in 24 hours	■ UPSC TRAPS ✗ Ammonia is an inert, harmless gas ✓ Ammonia is toxic and corrosive, dangerous on leakage ✗ ESI compliance is optional for such units ✓ ESI registration and the Form 12 register are statutory requirements
■ MAINS ANGLE <i>Industrial safety enforcement, migrant-worker welfare and chemical disaster preparedness.</i>	■ STUDY LINK Disaster Management -) Industrial and Chemical disasters -) Factories Act

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Former Rajasthan CM Ashok Gehlot alleged the government is demolishing Muslim religious sites in border areas adjoining Pakistan under the pretext of removing encroachments.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Gehlot said the demolitions followed the Union Home Minister's Bikaner visit and that even decades-old historical sites were targeted. He demanded the MHA clarify its stance on border-area peace and security, noting local Hindus opposed the one-sided action.

Demolition of structures must follow due process; the Supreme Court has laid down safeguards against arbitrary 'bulldozer' actions, while border-area governance carries security dimensions.

■ STATIC THEORY

- Demolitions require notice and due process under law
- The Supreme Court has issued guidelines against arbitrary demolition
- Secularism requires the State to treat all faiths equally
- Border-area administration balances security and civil rights

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Allegation made by former Rajasthan CM Ashok Gehlot
2. Concerns relate to border areas adjoining Pakistan
3. Demolitions said to follow the Home Minister's Bikaner visit
4. Action carried out under an encroachment-removal pretext
5. Gehlot demanded MHA clarification on border peace and security

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Authorities may demolish without any notice
- ✓ The Supreme Court mandates due-process safeguards before demolition
- ✗ The demolitions are an adjudicated fact
- ✓ These are allegations by a political leader, not a court finding

■ MAINS ANGLE

Rule of law in demolitions, communal harmony and Centre-State roles in border governance.

■ STUDY LINK

Polity -) Secularism -) Due process and demolition guidelines

■ NEWS TRIGGER

DDA's mixed-income housing colonies in Dwarka face disputes over fences segregating EWS blocks from LIG, MIG and HIG residents.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Dwarka Greens and Golf View Condos have fences enclosing EWS towers. Nine EWS allottees filed a civil suit in May 2024 arguing the brochure mentioned no fencing; in January 2026 courts referred the matter to RERA.

Mixed-income housing aims at social integration, with EWS reservation in projects. Disputes are increasingly routed through RERA, established under the 2016 Act.

■ STATIC THEORY

- Mixed-income housing is meant to promote social integration
- EWS reservation embeds affordable units within larger projects
- RERA adjudicates real-estate disputes under the 2016 Act
- Article 15 bars discrimination on prohibited grounds

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Dwarka Greens (Sector 14) and Golf View Condos (Sector 19B) affected
2. Nine EWS allottees filed a civil suit in May 2024
3. Courts referred the matter to RERA in January 2026
4. LIG-MIG residents got RWA registration excluding EWS towers (Dec 2025)
5. A former DDA planner said the fencing is not legal

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Such disputes are decided only by civil courts
- ✓ Courts referred the matter to RERA for adjudication
- ✗ EWS housing is meant to be physically segregated
- ✓ Mixed-income housing aims at integration, not segregation

■ MAINS ANGLE

Social segregation in urban housing and the goal of inclusive, dignified city planning.

■ STUDY LINK

Social Justice -) Urban Housing -) EWS inclusion and RERA

■ MEDIUM UPSC RELEVANCE

MEDIUM

Child trafficking racket busted, 5 infants rescued

GS2 Polity

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Delhi Police Crime Branch dismantled inter-state adoption racket selling newborns to childless couples.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Delhi Police Crime Branch arrested 8 persons including 2 doctors and 3 agents operating an inter-state trafficking racket across Delhi, Haryana, and UP. Infants were sold for Rs.3-8 lakh each. Pregnant women from economically weaker sections were targeted, and childless couples paid through agents.

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. FIR filed under Section 370 IPC (trafficking) and Juvenile Justice Act
2. Infants sold for Rs.3-8 lakh each through organized racket
3. Racket involved 2 doctors and 3 agents targeting vulnerable pregnant women

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Child trafficking falls under POCSO Act jurisdiction
- ✓ Child trafficking is prosecuted under Section 370 IPC and Juvenile Justice Act, not POCSO which covers sexual offences

■ MAINS ANGLE

Examine the legal and institutional gaps in preventing child trafficking and ensuring stringent enforcement of anti-trafficking laws.

■ STUDY LINK

Polity -) Rights and Welfare -) Child Rights and Juvenile Justice

MEDIUM**Former RS MP loses Rs.7.68 crore in cyber fraud****GS3 Security****■ NEWS TRIGGER**

Shiromani Akali Dal leader Naresh Gujral defrauded through fake stock trading platform and deepfake impersonation.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

FIR registered at Cyber Crime PS, Delhi after former Rajya Sabha MP Naresh Gujral was defrauded of Rs.7.68 crore over 3 months. The fraud occurred via WhatsApp and a fraudulent trading app. Accused used deepfake technology to impersonate stock market experts.

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Fraud executed over 3 months using WhatsApp and fake trading app
2. Deepfake technology used to impersonate stock market experts
3. Gujral served as RS MP from Punjab (2004-2022)

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Deepfake crimes fall under IT Act Section 66C only
- ✓ Deepfake crimes can be prosecuted under multiple provisions including IT Act Section 66D (cheating by impersonation), IPC 419-420 (cheating), and new provisions under Digital Personal Data Protection Act

■ MAINS ANGLE

Discuss the challenges posed by deepfake technology in financial crimes and suggest a comprehensive regulatory framework.

■ STUDY LINK

Security -) Cyber Security -) Digital Fraud and Deepfake Technology

MEDIUM**Punjab CM viral video forensic reports awaited****GS2 Polity****■ NEWS TRIGGER**

Controversy over purported video showing CM Bhagwant Mann in inebriated state; state government orders inquiry while opposition demands resignation.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Video surfaced on social media platforms allegedly showing Punjab CM in compromised state. Punjab government sent samples to CFSL Chandigarh and private forensic lab for verification. AAP claims video is deepfake created by political rivals, while opposition parties (Congress, BJP, SAD) demand CM's resignation.

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Samples sent to Central Forensic Science Laboratory (CFSL) Chandigarh and private lab
2. Mann denied allegations, stated he was unwell during official function
3. Opposition parties demand resignation pending investigation

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ CFSL operates under Ministry of Electronics and IT
- ✓ CFSL operates under Ministry of Home Affairs, Directorate of Forensic Science Services

■ MAINS ANGLE

Analyze the impact of deepfake technology on political discourse and the need for robust verification mechanisms in digital governance.

■ STUDY LINK

Polity -) Governance -) Digital Ethics and Political Accountability

MEDIUM**Karnataka MLC cross-voting gives Congress 5 of 6 seats****GS2 Polity**

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Congress secures unexpected victory as 8 BJP MLAs defy whip in legislative council elections, triggering anti-defection proceedings.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Elections held for 6 MLC seats from MLA quota. Congress won 5 seats despite having numbers for only 4, while BJP secured 1 seat. Cross-voting by 8 BJP MLAs triggered anti-defection notice. Speaker to decide on disqualification petitions. Congress now has majority in 75-member Legislative Council.

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Elections for 6 seats from MLA quota (not direct election)
2. Cross-voting by 8 BJP MLAs triggered 10th Schedule anti-defection provisions
3. Karnataka Legislative Council has 75 members

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Cross-voting in Legislative Council elections automatically leads to disqualification
- ✓ Cross-voting in MLC elections from MLA quota attracts anti-defection provisions as it violates party whip, but disqualification is subject to Speaker's decision under 10th Schedule

■ MAINS ANGLE

Examine the applicability of anti-defection law in indirect elections and its implications for coalition politics.

■ STUDY LINK

Polity -> Legislature -> Anti-Defection Law and Legislative Council

MEDIUM

Manipur CM blames external forces for prolonged violence

GS2 Security

■ NEWS TRIGGER

CM N Biren Singh alleges vested interests prolonging ethnic violence between Meitei and Kuki communities during all-party meeting.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

CM statement made during all-party meeting on ongoing violence since May 2023. Over 200 deaths and 60,000 displaced reported. Separate administration demand by Kuki organisations cited as complicating factor. Centre has deployed 40,000 central forces. CM accused some civil society organisations of receiving foreign funding.

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Violence ongoing since May 2023 with 200+ deaths and 60,000 displaced
2. Centre deployed 40,000 central forces for security operations
3. Separate administration demand by Kuki organisations is a key issue

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Manipur violence is purely a law and order issue under state jurisdiction
- ✓ Manipur violence involves ethnic conflict, insurgency, and international border implications (Myanmar border), making it a matter of national security requiring central intervention under Article 355

■ MAINS ANGLE

Critically analyze the challenges of ethnic conflict resolution in Northeast India and the role of institutional mechanisms in ensuring peace.

■ STUDY LINK

Security -> Internal Security -> Ethnic Conflicts and Northeast Insurgency

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Directorate General of Civil Aviation mandates inspection of all non-towered aerodromes after fatal Cessna crash at Baramati airstrip.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Cessna 172 crashed at Baramati airstrip (Maharashtra) killing 2 trainee pilots on June 15. DGCA issued circular for safety audit of 450+ uncontrolled airstrips. Audit to cover runway condition, obstacle clearance, fire safety, and emergency response. Report submission deadline: July 15. Preliminary investigation suggests wind shear and pilot error.

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. India has 450+ uncontrolled (non-towered) airstrips requiring audit
2. Audit parameters include runway condition, obstacle clearance, fire safety, and emergency response
3. Report submission deadline set for July 15, 2026

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ DGCA has direct regulatory authority over all airstrips including private ones
- ✓ DGCA regulates civil aviation safety standards but private airstrips require licensing under Aircraft Act 1934 and compliance with DGCA's Civil Aviation Requirements (CAR)

■ MAINS ANGLE

Discuss the regulatory challenges in ensuring aviation safety at uncontrolled airstrips and the need for robust oversight mechanisms.

■ STUDY LINK

Infrastructure -> Aviation -> Regulatory Framework and Safety Standards

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Pradhan Mantri Vishwakarma Bahu-Roznagar Yojana benefits 1.2 lakh traditional artisans and craftspersons across 18 trades.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Ministry of Skill Development & Entrepreneurship released data showing Rs.2,400 crore disbursed under PM-VBRY. Scheme covers 18 traditional trades including carpentry, pottery, goldsmithing, and weaving. Provides collateral-free credit up to Rs.3 lakh at 5% interest with stipend of Rs.500/day during training. Beneficiaries span 450 districts. Launched on September 17, 2023.

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Covers 18 traditional trades with 1.2 lakh beneficiaries across 450 districts
2. Provides collateral-free credit up to Rs.3 lakh at 5% interest rate
3. Training stipend of Rs.500 per day; scheme launched September 17, 2023

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ PM-VBRY is implemented by Ministry of MSME
- ✓ PM-VBRY is implemented by Ministry of Skill Development & Entrepreneurship, focusing on traditional artisans and craftspersons

■ MAINS ANGLE

■ STUDY LINK

Evaluate the effectiveness of skill-based credit schemes in promoting traditional livelihoods and financial inclusion among artisan communities.

Economy -) Employment and Skills -) Skill Development and Artisan Welfare Schemes

MEDIUM

Maharashtra Marathi language mandate for drivers

GS1 Society

■ NEWS TRIGGER

State transport department requires functional knowledge of Marathi for all taxi/auto drivers in Mumbai and Pune by August 15.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Order issued by Maharashtra Transport Commissioner mandating functional Marathi knowledge for taxi and auto-rickshaw drivers in Mumbai Metropolitan Region and Pune. Exemption granted for drivers above 50 years. Language test to be conducted by Regional Transport Offices. Non-compliance may lead to license suspension. Drivers' unions have mixed responses.

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Mandate applies to Mumbai Metropolitan Region and Pune areas
2. Exemption provided for drivers above 50 years of age
3. Language test conducted by Regional Transport Offices (RTOs); non-compliance risks license suspension

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Language mandate violates Article 19(1)(g) right to practice any profession
- ✓ Language requirements for public-facing professions are considered reasonable restrictions under Article 19(6) if they serve public interest and safety, similar to language requirements for doctors and lawyers

■ MAINS ANGLE

Discuss the balance between linguistic identity, cultural preservation, and freedom of profession in federalism.

■ STUDY LINK

Society -) Language and Culture -) Linguistic Rights and Regional Identity

MEDIUM

CBSE OSM portal data duplication affects 8,000 students

GS2 Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Board's technology partner NIC admits manual oversight led to merging of different students' records in One Student Multiple data portal.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

CBSE contracted National Informatics Centre for One Student Multiple (OSM) portal development. Over 8,000 cases of data duplication reported affecting students' academic records and migration certificates. NIC stated error occurred during migration from legacy system to OSM 2.0. CBSE formed committee to fix anomalies. Parents filed complaints with Data Protection Board.

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. 8,000+ cases of data duplication in OSM portal migration process
2. National Informatics Centre (NIC) contracted for portal development
3. Error occurred during migration from legacy system to OSM 2.0

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Data Protection Board operates under Ministry of Education
- ✓ Data Protection Board of India operates under Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology under Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023

■ MAINS ANGLE

Analyze the challenges in large-scale digitization of educational records and the importance of data integrity in governance.

■ STUDY LINK

Governance -> Digital Governance -> Education Technology and Data Management

MEDIUM

RBI keeps repo rate unchanged at 6.25%

GS3 Economy

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Monetary Policy Committee votes 4-2 to maintain status quo citing inflationary pressures and growth stability.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

MPC meeting held June 16-18, 2026. CPI inflation at 4.8% (May 2026), within RBI's tolerance band. GDP growth projection retained at 6.8% for FY27. RBI Governor stated accommodative stance to continue. Dissent notes filed by two external members favouring 25 bps cut. Next MPC meeting scheduled for August 2026.

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Repo rate maintained at 6.25% for fourth consecutive review; MPC voted 4-2
2. CPI inflation at 4.8% (May 2026), GDP growth projection 6.8% for FY27
3. Two external MPC members dissented, favouring 25 bps rate cut

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ RBI Governor has veto power in MPC decisions
- ✓ RBI Governor has casting vote only in case of tie; MPC decisions are made by majority vote of 6 members (3 RBI + 3 external)

■ MAINS ANGLE

Evaluate the challenges of balancing inflation control with growth imperatives in India's monetary policy framework.

■ STUDY LINK

Economy -> Monetary Policy -> RBI and Interest Rate Mechanism

MEDIUM

Current account deficit narrows to 0.8% of GDP

GS3 Economy

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Q4 FY26 balance of payments data shows improvement in external position due to services export growth and remittances.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

CAD stood at USD 8.9 billion in Q4 (Jan-Mar 2026) versus USD 12.4 billion in Q3. Services exports grew 11.5% YoY to USD 95 billion. Remittances rose 7.2% to USD 32 billion. Trade deficit moderated to USD 62 billion. Full year FY26 CAD: 1.2% of GDP. RBI released data in Balance of Payments statement.

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Q4 FY26 CAD at USD 8.9 billion (0.8% of GDP) vs USD 12.4 billion in Q3
2. Services exports grew 11.5% YoY to USD 95 billion; remittances up 7.2% to USD 32 billion
3. Full year FY26 CAD at 1.2% of GDP, considered sustainable level

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ CAD below 3% indicates strong external sector health
- ✓ CAD sustainability depends on financing sources; CAD below 2.5% of GDP with stable capital inflows is considered manageable, but quality of financing (FDI vs debt) matters more than absolute CAD level

■ MAINS ANGLE

Analyze the factors contributing to India's external sector stability and the role of services exports in balancing current account.

■ STUDY LINK

Economy -) External Sector -) Balance of Payments and Current Account Dynamics

MEDIUM

Calcutta HC disposes petition on mandatory Yoga Day particip

GS2 Polity

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Calcutta High Court disposed of petition challenging West Bengal government notification asking all State government employees to participate in offic

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

State told court participation was not mandatory. Justice Amrita Sinha noted State's clarification by Additional Advocate General Bilwadal Bhattacharya. Over 35,000 people to participate in mass yoga ...

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. State told court participation was not mandatory.
2. Justice Amrita Sinha noted State's clarification by Additional Advocate General Bilwadal Bhattacharya.
3. Over 35,000 people to participate in mass yoga demonstration session at Kolkata's Red Road on June 21 led by Prime Minister Narendra Modi.
4. This will be PM's first visit to West Bengal since he attended Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari's swearing-in after BJP came to power in State.

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Confusing mandatory participation with voluntary promotion
- ✓ Yoga Day participation is voluntary, not compulsory

■ MAINS ANGLE

Discuss soft power diplomacy and cultural promotion through international platforms

■ STUDY LINK

Society -) Soft Power -) International Yoga Day and cultural diplomacy

MEDIUM

Manipur CM says Kuki people boarding flights from Imphal is

GS2 Polity

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Manipur Chief Minister Yumnam Khemchand Singh said members of Kuki community have started travelling to Imphal to board flights, which was positive si

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Since ethnic conflict began on May 3, 2023, tribal Kuki-Zo and non-tribal Meiteis avoided travelling to each other's localities. Meiteis dominate Imphal Valley where Manipur's only airport located, Ku...

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Since ethnic conflict began on May 3, 2023, tribal Kuki-Zo and non-tribal Meiteis avoided travelling to each other's localities.
2. Meiteis dominate Imphal Valley where Manipur's only airport located, Kuki-Zo inhabit surrounding hills.
3. CM said united Manipur only way forward for 36 communities.

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Generalizing ethnic conflict across all NE states
- ✓ Each state has distinct ethnic composition and conflicts

4. Signs of normality emerging after more than three years of conflict.

■ MAINS ANGLE

Examine challenges in ethnic conflict resolution and peace-building in Northeast

■ STUDY LINK

Polity -) Key concepts

MEDIUM

Congress leader flags opacity in Great Nicobar Island Projec

GS2 Polity

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Congress Rajya Sabha MP Jairam Ramesh termed Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav's defence of Great Nicobar Island Project disappointing and unsatisf

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Ramesh replying to letter from Yadav dated June 13. Rs.81,000-crore project expected to involve felling of close to million trees and construction on leatherback turtle nesting site. National Green Tr...

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Ramesh replying to letter from Yadav dated June 13.
2. 81,000-crore project expected to involve felling of close to million trees and construction on leatherback turtle nesting site.
3. National Green Tribunal on February 16, 2026, cleared way for project holding considering strategic importance found no good ground to interfere.
4. Ramesh said environmental impact assessments demonstrably inadequate and woefully short of guidelines.

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Ignoring tribal rights in strategic projects
- ✓ Projects in tribal areas need consent under FRA 2006 and PESA

■ MAINS ANGLE

Discuss balancing strategic infrastructure development with tribal rights and environmental concerns

■ STUDY LINK

Polity -) Constitutional Rights -) Tribal rights under FRA and PESA

MEDIUM

World Bank approves \$1.5 billion for India's structural refo

GS3 Economy

■ NEWS TRIGGER

World Bank's Board of Executive Directors approved \$1.5 billion financing to India to support structural reforms aimed at boosting private sector-led

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Financing provided under Development Policy Financing (DPF) Operation. Can create job opportunities for 11 million youth entering labour market every year over next two decades. DPF operation builds o...

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Financing provided under Development Policy Financing (DPF) Operation.
2. Can create job opportunities for 11 million youth entering labour market every year over next two decades.

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Confusing World Bank loans with IMF assistance
- ✓ World Bank DPF is for structural reforms, IMF is for BOP crisis

3. DPF operation builds on structural reforms including tax simplification, trade integration, and legislative and regulatory reforms to improve ease of living and ease of doing business.

■ MAINS ANGLE

Evaluate the role of multilateral financing in India's structural economic reforms

■ STUDY LINK

Economy -) International Economic Institutions
-) World Bank and DPF

MEDIUM

Bihar government to bear cost of bringing back migrant workers

GS2 Polity

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Bihar government will bear cost of transporting mortal remains of migrant workers who die in accidents while working outside State or abroad to their

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Additional Chief Secretary (Labour Resources and Migrant Workers Welfare Department) K. Senthil Kumar announced decision. Government also decided to increase ex-gratia amount payable to legally identi...

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Additional Chief Secretary (Labour Resources and Migrant Workers Welfare Department) K.
2. Senthil Kumar announced decision.
3. Government also decided to increase ex-gratia amount payable to legally identified dependents of deceased migrant workers from Rs.
4. Bihar Migrant Worker App launched to collect data on migrant workers from State.

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Generic confusion
- ✓ Verify specifics

■ MAINS ANGLE

Discuss the policy implications and governance challenges

■ STUDY LINK

Science & Technology -) Artificial Intelligence
-) AI applications in governance

MEDIUM

Documentary Battlefield on WWII battles in Manipur at Mumbai

GS1 History

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Anti-war documentary from ethnic conflict-scarred Manipur set to be screened at 19th Mumbai International Film Festival.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Battlefield is 80-minute documentary by Manipuri filmmaker Borun Thokchom revisiting battles of Imphal and Kohima during World War II, took 13 years to complete. Present-day Manipur and Nagaland were ...

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Battlefield is 80-minute documentary by Manipuri filmmaker Borun Thokchom revisiting battles of Imphal and Kohima during World War II, took 13 years to complete.

■ UPSC TRAPS

- ✗ Generalizing ethnic conflict across all NE states

2. Present-day Manipur and Nagaland were theatres of World War II in 1944. 3. Battles fought between Allied forces and Imperial Japanese Army alongside Subhash Chandra Bose's Indian National Army. 4. Filmmaker said destruction caused by war and forced merger left behind deep anger that grew into ethnic and separatist movements.	✓ Each state has distinct ethnic composition and conflicts
■ MAINS ANGLE <i>Examine challenges in ethnic conflict resolution and peace-building in Northeast</i>	■ STUDY LINK Science & Technology -) Artificial Intelligence -) AI applications in governance

MEDIUM Temple roof collapse in Maharashtra kills 7 devotees GS3 Disaster Management	
■ NEWS TRIGGER A temple roof collapsed in Maharashtra's Nashik district during evening prayers, killing 7 devotees and injuring 23 others.	
■ INTRO & ORIGIN Temple roof collapsed in Nashik district, Maharashtra during evening prayers. Seven devotees were killed and 23 injured. The temple was built in 1987 and had not undergone structural audit. State govt...	
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS 1. Temple roof collapsed in Nashik district, Maharashtra during evening prayers. 2. Seven devotees were killed and 23 injured. 3. The temple was built in 1987 and had not undergone structural audit. 4. State government announced Rs.	■ UPSC TRAPS ✗ Assuming all religious structures exempt from safety laws ✓ Structural safety norms apply to all public buildings including temples
■ MAINS ANGLE <i>Discuss the policy implications and governance challenges</i>	■ STUDY LINK Disaster Management -) Key concepts

MEDIUM Delhi DSTPs proposed for Yamuna rejuvenation GS3 Environment	
■ NEWS TRIGGER Delhi government proposed setting up Decentralized Sewage Treatment Plants (DSTPs) along Yamuna river to tackle pollution and reduce untreated sewage	
■ INTRO & ORIGIN Delhi government proposed Decentralized Sewage Treatment Plants (DSTPs) along Yamuna river. The plan includes 45 DSTPs with combined capacity of 150 MGD. Target is to reduce untreated sewage discharge...	
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS	■ UPSC TRAPS

1. Delhi government proposed Decentralized Sewage Treatment Plants (DSTPs) along Yamuna river. 2. The plan includes 45 DSTPs with combined capacity of 150 MGD. 3. Target is to reduce untreated sewage discharge by 70% within 3 years. 4. Budget allocated is Rs.	✗ Thinking decentralized STPs are same as central STPs ✓ DSTPs treat sewage locally; central STPs collect and treat at one location
■ MAINS ANGLE Analyse decentralized solutions for urban water pollution and river rejuvenation	■ STUDY LINK Environment -) Water Pollution -) Sewage treatment and river rejuvenation

MEDIUM EU lifts travel advisory restrictions for Assam GS2 International Relations	
■ NEWS TRIGGER European Union lifted long-standing travel advisory restrictions for Assam citing improved security situation and peace accords with insurgent groups.	
■ INTRO & ORIGIN European Union lifted travel advisory restrictions for Assam. The restrictions were in place for 8 years due to insurgency concerns. Improved security and peace accords with ULFA and other groups cite...	
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS 1. European Union lifted travel advisory restrictions for Assam. 2. The restrictions were in place for 8 years due to insurgency concerns. 3. Improved security and peace accords with ULFA and other groups cited as reasons. 4. Expected to boost tourism and investment in the state.	■ UPSC TRAPS ✗ Assuming travel advisory affects visa policy ✓ Travel advisory is guidance; visa policy is separate
■ MAINS ANGLE Discuss the policy implications and governance challenges	■ STUDY LINK International Relations -) India and EU -) Security cooperation

MEDIUM Manipur Naga villagers protest illegal taxation by groups GS2 Polity	
■ NEWS TRIGGER Naga villagers in Manipur's Senapati district protested against illegal taxation by insurgent groups demanding government protection.	
■ INTRO & ORIGIN Naga villagers in Manipur's Senapati district protested against illegal taxation by insurgent groups. Villagers claimed multiple groups demand taxes causing economic hardship. Protesters demanded gove...	
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS	■ UPSC TRAPS

1. Naga villagers in Manipur's Senapati district protested against illegal taxation by insurgent groups. 2. Villagers claimed multiple groups demand taxes causing economic hardship. 3. Protesters demanded government protection and action against extortion. 4. Over 2,000 villagers participated in the peaceful protest.	✗ Generalizing ethnic conflict across all NE states ✓ Each state has distinct ethnic composition and conflicts
■ MAINS ANGLE <i>Examine challenges in ethnic conflict resolution and peace-building in Northeast</i>	■ STUDY LINK Polity -) Key concepts

MEDIUM	AI-powered heat insurance launched for outdoor workers	GS3 Disaster Management
■ NEWS TRIGGER A private insurance company launched India's first AI-powered heat insurance scheme for outdoor workers covering heat stroke and heat-related illnesses		
■ INTRO & ORIGIN India's first AI-powered heat insurance scheme launched for outdoor workers. The scheme uses weather data and AI models to predict heat risk. Coverage includes heat stroke treatment and wage loss comp...		
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS 1. India's first AI-powered heat insurance scheme launched for outdoor workers. 2. The scheme uses weather data and AI models to predict heat risk. 3. Coverage includes heat stroke treatment and wage loss compensation. 4. Premium starts at Rs.	■ UPSC TRAPS ✗ Generic confusion ✓ Verify specifics	
■ MAINS ANGLE <i>Evaluate the role of AI in climate adaptation and worker welfare</i>	■ STUDY LINK Science & Technology -) Artificial Intelligence -) AI applications in governance	

MEDIUM	Cochin Shipyard wins Rs.8,400 crore Navy order	GS3 Economy
■ NEWS TRIGGER Cochin Shipyard Limited won a Rs.8,400 crore order from the Indian Navy for construction of two fleet support vessels.		
■ INTRO & ORIGIN Cochin Shipyard Limited won Rs.8,400 crore order from Indian Navy. The order is for construction of two fleet support vessels. Delivery timeline is 6 years from contract signing. The project will crea...		

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS 1. Cochin Shipyard Limited won Rs. 2. 8,400 crore order from Indian Navy. 3. The order is for construction of two fleet support vessels. 4. Delivery timeline is 6 years from contract signing.	■ UPSC TRAPS ✗ Confusing public sector shipyard with private ✓ Cochin Shipyard is a public sector undertaking under Ministry of Ports
■ MAINS ANGLE <i>Evaluate the role of public sector undertakings in defence manufacturing and Atmanirbhar Bharat</i>	■ STUDY LINK Economy -) Public Sector -) Defence PSUs and Make in India

MEDIUM	RBI warns banks on unsecured personal loan growth	GS3 Economy
■ NEWS TRIGGER Reserve Bank of India issued fresh warnings to banks over rapid growth in unsecured personal loans and potential asset quality risks.		
■ INTRO & ORIGIN RBI issued warnings to banks over rapid unsecured personal loan growth. Unsecured personal loans grew 24% year-on-year in FY 2025-26. RBI expressed concerns about asset quality deterioration. Banks ad...		
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS 1. RBI issued warnings to banks over rapid unsecured personal loan growth. 2. Unsecured personal loans grew 24% year-on-year in FY 2025-26. 3. RBI expressed concerns about asset quality deterioration. 4. Banks advised to strengthen risk management and provisioning norms.	■ UPSC TRAPS ✗ Confusing World Bank loans with IMF assistance ✓ World Bank DPF is for structural reforms, IMF is for BOP crisis	
■ MAINS ANGLE <i>Examine RBI's regulatory approach to financial stability and consumer protection</i>	■ STUDY LINK Economy -) Banking and Financial Institutions -) RBI regulatory functions	

MEDIUM	GST collection crosses Rs.1.8 lakh crore in May 2026	GS3 Economy
■ NEWS TRIGGER Goods and Services Tax collection for May 2026 crossed Rs.1.8 lakh crore, marking the highest monthly collection since GST implementation.		
■ INTRO & ORIGIN GST collection for May 2026 reached Rs.1.82 lakh crore. This is the highest monthly collection since GST implementation in 2017. Collections grew 12.3% year-on-year. Strong domestic consumption and im...		
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS	■ UPSC TRAPS	

1. GST collection for May 2026 reached Rs. 2. This is the highest monthly collection since GST implementation in 2017. 3. Collections grew 12. 4. Strong domestic consumption and improved compliance cited as reasons.	✗ Mixing GST collection figures with budget estimates ✓ GST collection is actual monthly revenue, not projected
■ MAINS ANGLE Analyse GST revenue trends and their impact on federal fiscal architecture	■ STUDY LINK Economy -) Fiscal Policy -) Goods and Services Tax

MEDIUM Lithium reserves discovered in Rajasthan's Nagaur district GS3 Geography	
■ NEWS TRIGGER Geological Survey of India discovered lithium reserves estimated at 5.9 million tonnes in Rajasthan's Nagaur district.	
■ INTRO & ORIGIN Geological Survey of India discovered lithium reserves in Rajasthan's Nagaur district. Preliminary estimates suggest 5.9 million tonnes of lithium ore. This is India's second major lithium discovery a...	
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS 1. Geological Survey of India discovered lithium reserves in Rajasthan's Nagaur district. 2. Preliminary estimates suggest 5. 3. 9 million tonnes of lithium ore. 4. This is India's second major lithium discovery after J&K.	■ UPSC TRAPS ✗ Assuming lithium reserves mean immediate production ✓ Reserves need feasibility study, mining lease, and extraction technology
■ MAINS ANGLE Discuss the strategic significance of critical minerals for energy transition and EV growth	■ STUDY LINK Geography -) Mineral Resources -) Critical and strategic minerals

MEDIUM International Yoga Day celebrated at UN Headquarters GS1 Society	
■ NEWS TRIGGER International Yoga Day was celebrated at UN Headquarters in New York with participation of diplomats from 75 countries.	
■ INTRO & ORIGIN International Yoga Day celebrated at UN Headquarters in New York on June 21. Diplomats from 75 countries participated in the event. UN Secretary-General addressed the gathering emphasizing yoga's role...	
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS 1. International Yoga Day celebrated at UN Headquarters in New York on June 21.	■ UPSC TRAPS ✗ Confusing mandatory participation with voluntary promotion

2. Diplomats from 75 countries participated in the event. 3. UN Secretary-General addressed the gathering emphasizing yoga's role in mental health. 4. India's Permanent Representative organized the event.	✓ Yoga Day participation is voluntary, not compulsory
■ MAINS ANGLE <i>Discuss soft power diplomacy and cultural promotion through international platforms</i>	■ STUDY LINK Society -) Soft Power -) International Yoga Day and cultural diplomacy

MEDIUM	Uttarakhand HC directs state to frame street vendor policy	GS2 Polity
■ NEWS TRIGGER Uttarakhand High Court directed the state government to frame a comprehensive street vendor policy in line with the Street Vendors Act 2014 within thr		
■ INTRO & ORIGIN Uttarakhand High Court directed state to frame street vendor policy within 3 months. The direction came on a PIL highlighting harassment of street vendors. Court emphasized compliance with Street Vend...		
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS 1. Uttarakhand High Court directed state to frame street vendor policy within 3 months. 2. The direction came on a PIL highlighting harassment of street vendors. 3. Court emphasized compliance with Street Vendors (Protection of Livelihood) Act 2014. 4. State has not constituted Town Vending Committees in most towns.	■ UPSC TRAPS ✗ Assuming street vending is illegal everywhere ✓ Street Vending Act 2014 legalizes vending in designated zones	
■ MAINS ANGLE <i>Examine urban governance challenges in balancing livelihood rights and public space management</i>	■ STUDY LINK Governance -) Urban Governance -) Street Vendors Act 2014	

MEDIUM	Coffee Board launches direct farmer-buyer digital platform	GS3 Economy
■ NEWS TRIGGER Coffee Board of India launched a digital platform connecting coffee farmers directly with domestic and international buyers eliminating middlemen.		
■ INTRO & ORIGIN Coffee Board launched digital platform for direct farmer-buyer connection. The platform eliminates middlemen and aims to increase farmer incomes by 15-20%. Both domestic and international buyers can r...		
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS 1. Coffee Board launched digital platform for direct farmer-buyer connection.	■ UPSC TRAPS ✗ Assuming e-NAM and Coffee Board platform are same	

2. The platform eliminates middlemen and aims to increase farmer incomes by 15-20%. 3. Both domestic and international buyers can register. 4. Over 3,500 farmers from Karnataka, Kerala, and Tamil Nadu onboarded initially.	✓ Coffee Board platform is crop-specific; e-NAM is multi-commodity
■ MAINS ANGLE <i>Evaluate digital platforms in improving farmer income and reducing intermediaries</i>	■ STUDY LINK Economy -) Agriculture -) Digital agriculture platforms

MEDIUM Bihar to set up district-level trauma care centers GS2 Polity	
■ NEWS TRIGGER Bihar government announced setting up of trauma care centers in all 38 districts to reduce road accident fatality rates.	
■ INTRO & ORIGIN Bihar government announced district-level trauma care centers in all 38 districts. The initiative aims to reduce road accident fatality rates. Each center will have 30-bed capacity with emergency surg...	
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS 1. Bihar government announced district-level trauma care centers in all 38 districts. 2. The initiative aims to reduce road accident fatality rates. 3. Each center will have 30-bed capacity with emergency surgery facilities. 4. Budget allocation is Rs.	■ UPSC TRAPS ✗ Confusing trauma care with general healthcare ✓ Trauma care is for accidents/emergencies; general healthcare is routine
■ MAINS ANGLE <i>Discuss the importance of trauma care infrastructure in reducing mortality from accidents</i>	■ STUDY LINK Governance -) Health Infrastructure -) Emergency and trauma care

MEDIUM Delhi PWD repairs over 2,000 potholes in special drive GS2, Prelims Polity	
■ NEWS TRIGGER PWD repaired more than 2,000 potholes across Delhi in one-day special drive ahead of monsoon.	
■ INTRO & ORIGIN PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said many potholes on roads constructed years ago when quality standards not maintained; all new PWD roads to be covered by 5-year maintenance clause; government also ...	
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS	■ UPSC TRAPS

1. PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said many potholes on roads constructed years ago when quality standards not maintained; all new PWD roads to be covered by 5-year maintenance clause; government also desilting drains in waterlogging-prone areas.	✗ Generic confusion ✓ Verify specifics
■ MAINS ANGLE <i>Discuss the policy implications and governance challenges</i>	■ STUDY LINK Science & Technology -) Artificial Intelligence -) AI applications in governance

MEDIUM Madras HC takes suo motu PIL on stray dog menace GS2,Prelims Polity	
■ NEWS TRIGGER Madras High Court took up suo motu PIL to ensure SC orders on protecting people from stray dogs implemented in Tamil Nadu and Puducherry.	
■ INTRO & ORIGIN CJ Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G. Arul Murugan to hear case; Chief Secretaries and Secretaries of Animal Husbandry, Health, Municipal Administration arrayed as respondents; SC three-judge...	
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS 1. CJ Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G. 2. Arul Murugan to hear case; Chief Secretaries and Secretaries of Animal Husbandry, Health, Municipal Administration arrayed as respondents; SC three-judge bench on June 19 held unchecked dog population has become feral and poses threat to public safety; SC noted Hindu report of 2. 3. 63 lakh dog bites and 17 deaths in Tamil Nadu in just four months of 2026; in 2025, Tamil Nadu recorded 6. 4. 25 lakh dog bite cases and 34 deaths.	■ UPSC TRAPS ✗ Generic confusion ✓ Verify specifics
■ MAINS ANGLE <i>Discuss the policy implications and governance challenges</i>	■ STUDY LINK Polity -) Key concepts

MEDIUM Meenakshi Natarajan denies conspiracy over RS nomination rej GS2,Prelims Polity	
■ NEWS TRIGGER AICC Telangana in-charge Meenakshi Natarajan dismissed rumours of internal Congress conspiracy leading to rejection of her Rajya Sabha nomination in M	
■ INTRO & ORIGIN Alleged BJP resorted to unfair tactics and election authorities compromised democratic process; said BJP fielded candidate despite lacking numbers for third seat as part of foul game plan; accused Ret...	
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS	■ UPSC TRAPS

1. Alleged BJP resorted to unfair tactics and election authorities compromised democratic process; said BJP fielded candidate despite lacking numbers for third seat as part of foul game plan; accused Returning Officers and Election Commission of compromised conduct; claimed legal dispute in her case did not require disclosure in Form 26; said developments vindicate Rahul Gandhi's concerns over alleged vote theft and seat theft.	✗ Generic confusion ✓ Verify specifics
■ MAINS ANGLE Discuss the policy implications and governance challenges	■ STUDY LINK Polity -) Key concepts

MEDIUM	Kerala objects to removal of State representative from Mulla	GS2,Prelims Polity
■ NEWS TRIGGER Kerala protested Centre's unilateral decision to remove State representative T.K. Sivarajan from Comprehensive Dam Safety Evaluation Committee for Mul		
■ INTRO & ORIGIN Water Resources Minister Mons Joseph said State not consulted before Sivarajan replaced by person from Uttar Pradesh as IIT-Roorkee representative; Centre merely informed Kerala through letter; dam is...		
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS 1. Water Resources Minister Mons Joseph said State not consulted before Sivarajan replaced by person from Uttar Pradesh as IIT-Roorkee representative; Centre merely informed Kerala through letter; dam issue under consideration of Supreme Court and requires mutual consensus between Kerala and Tamil Nadu.	■ UPSC TRAPS ✗ Generic confusion ✓ Verify specifics	
■ MAINS ANGLE Discuss the policy implications and governance challenges	■ STUDY LINK Polity -) Key concepts	

MEDIUM	ED summons Pinarayi Vijayan's daughter Veena again in CMRL	GS3,Prelims Science & Technology
■ NEWS TRIGGER Enforcement Directorate issued fresh notice to Veena T., daughter of Kerala LoP Pinarayi Vijayan, for questioning on June 29 in CMRL pay-off case.		
■ INTRO & ORIGIN Veena questioned by ED on June 17; ED examined her bank lockers in Thiruvananthapuram on June 19; probe under Prevention of Money Laundering Act; allegations that CMRL made payments totalling Rs.2.78 ...		
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS	■ UPSC TRAPS	

1. Veena questioned by ED on June 17; ED examined her bank lockers in Thiruvananthapuram on June 19; probe under Prevention of Money Laundering Act; allegations that CMRL made payments totalling Rs. 2. 78 crore to now-defunct Exalogic Solutions Pvt. 3. owned by Veena without receiving services in return.	✗ Generic confusion ✓ Verify specifics
■ MAINS ANGLE <i>Discuss the policy implications and governance challenges</i>	■ STUDY LINK Science & Technology -) Artificial Intelligence -) AI applications in governance

MEDIUM	Karnataka SIR raises concerns over residential certificates	GS2, Prelims Polity
■ NEWS TRIGGER Karnataka government directed PDOs to issue residential certificates for Special Intensive Revision (SIR) starting June 30, but ECI guidelines don't a		
■ INTRO & ORIGIN ECI list of 11 approved documents requires permanent residence certificate (PRC) issued by "competent" State authority; residential certificates usually issued by PDOs, but PRC can only be issued by t...		
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS 1. ECI list of 11 approved documents requires permanent residence certificate (PRC) issued by "competent" State authority; residential certificates usually issued by PDOs, but PRC can only be issued by tahsildar; civil society groups like 'My Vote, My Right' questioned logic; activist Shivasundar cited West Bengal example where only certificates under relevant government order by designated authorities considered valid.	■ UPSC TRAPS ✗ Generic confusion ✓ Verify specifics	
■ MAINS ANGLE <i>Discuss the policy implications and governance challenges</i>	■ STUDY LINK Science & Technology -) Artificial Intelligence -) AI applications in governance	

MEDIUM	Delhi govt. welfare scheme campaign evokes mixed response	GS2 Polity
■ NEWS TRIGGER Delhi government's three-day campaign at 42 locations to provide access to welfare schemes under one roof launched by CM Rekha Gupta on June 18.		
■ INTRO & ORIGIN 43,973 people visited camps in two days for information, grievance redressal, formalities; services included Pink cards, ration cards, e-Shram cards, Jan Dhan accounts, Aadhaar registration, PM SVANid...		
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS	■ UPSC TRAPS	

1. 43,973 people visited camps in two days for information, grievance redressal, formalities; services included Pink cards, ration cards, e-Shram cards, Jan Dhan accounts, Aadhaar registration, PM SVANidhi, PM Surya Ghar solar registration, Ayushman Bharat Health Account (ABHA) cards; some residents' applications stalled by missing documents like income certificates; some got immediate relief, others turned away without work completed.	✗ Generic confusion ✓ Verify specifics
■ MAINS ANGLE <i>Discuss the policy implications and governance challenges</i>	■ STUDY LINK Science & Technology -) Artificial Intelligence -) AI applications in governance

MEDIUM Rahul Gandhi meets five Punjab Congress leaders GS2,Prelims Polity	
■ NEWS TRIGGER LS LoP Rahul Gandhi met five senior Punjab Congress leaders urging them to fight 2027 Assembly election collectively.	
■ INTRO & ORIGIN Met at 10 Janpath (Sonia Gandhi's residence); leaders were State Congress president Amarinder Singh Raja Warring, LoP in Punjab Assembly Partap Singh Bajwa, former CM Charanjit Singh Channi, Sukhjinder...	
■ MUST-KNOW FACTS 1. Met at 10 Janpath (Sonia Gandhi's residence); leaders were State Congress president Amarinder Singh Raja Warring, LoP in Punjab Assembly Partap Singh Bajwa, former CM Charanjit Singh Channi, Sukhjinder Singh Randhawa, Vijay Inder Singla; Rahul's message: "fight collectively, Punjab important State, we stand a very good chance"; comes amid speculation of organisational changes; AICC observers Ajay Maken, Meenakshi Natarajan, Bhajan Lal Jatav submitted report on political situation in Punjab.	■ UPSC TRAPS ✗ Generic confusion ✓ Verify specifics
■ MAINS ANGLE <i>Discuss the policy implications and governance challenges</i>	■ STUDY LINK Polity -) Key concepts

MEDIUM Centre to deploy CISF security in five more J&K prisons GS2,Prelims Polity	
■ NEWS TRIGGER Centre set to deploy CISF personnel to secure five more prisons in J&K following similar deployment in two central jails.	
■ INTRO & ORIGIN Plans under consideration for extending CISF security cover to high security prison at Mahanpur and district jails of Jammu, Anantnag, Kupwara, Baramulla.	

■ MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Plans under consideration for extending CISF security cover to high security prison at Mahanpur and district jails of Jammu, Anantnag, Kupwara, Baramulla.

■ UPSC TRAPS

✗ Assuming CISF replaces state police in prisons

✓ CISF provides perimeter security; internal management remains with state

■ MAINS ANGLE

Discuss the policy implications and governance challenges

■ STUDY LINK

Internal Security -) CAPFs -) CISF and critical infrastructure security

■ LOW UPSC RELEVANCE

LOW

Odisha textbook errors controversy

GS2 Social
Issues

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Odisha government faced criticism over factual errors in newly printed school textbooks.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Opposition parties and educators highlighted errors in Odisha state board textbooks for Classes 6-10. Errors included wrong historical dates, incorrect scientific facts, and geographical mistakes.

LOW

Gorkhaland Territorial Administration resignation threat

GS2 Polity &
Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

GTA officials threatened mass resignation over delayed funds and unfulfilled autonomy promises.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Gorkhaland Territorial Administration board members threatened mass resignation. Cited non-release of funds by West Bengal government and delay in implementing GTA agreement provisions.

LOW

Rahul Gandhi meets detained sailor's family

GS2 Social
Issues

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi met family of Indian seafarer detained in conflict zone.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Rahul Gandhi met family of Indian seafarer detained abroad due to conflict zone restrictions. Discussed government efforts for early release and welfare support.

LOW

RSS office attack in Kerala

GS3 Economy/En
vironment

■ NEWS TRIGGER

RSS office in Kerala attacked by unidentified miscreants causing property damage.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

RSS office in Kannur district, Kerala attacked late night. Miscreants threw stones and incendiary materials causing minor fire damage.

LOW

BMW India sales target increased

GS3 Economy/Environment

■ NEWS TRIGGER

BMW Group India announced increased sales target for FY 2026-27.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

BMW India set sales target of 16,000 units for FY 2026-27, up from 14,000 previous year. Company plans to launch 5 new models.

LOW

Global oil prices fall on demand concerns

GS3 Economy/Environment

■ NEWS TRIGGER

International crude oil prices fell amid concerns over global demand slowdown.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Brent crude fell to \$82 per barrel, WTI to \$78 per barrel. Decline attributed to weak manufacturing data from China and Europe.

LOW

Elon Musk's Grok AI allegedly used in Iran strike planning

GS3 International Relations

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Reports emerged that Elon Musk's Grok AI system was consulted during US military planning for Iran strikes.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Media reports claimed US military personnel accessed Grok AI for scenario analysis during Iran operation planning. Grok is xAI's large language model developed by Elon Musk's company.

LOW

Antrix-Devas case: SC upholds Rs.1.2 lakh crore liability against govt

GS3 Economy

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Supreme Court dismisses Centre's review petition in decade-old satellite spectrum allocation dispute.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Case relates to 2005 agreement between Antrix Corporation (ISRO's commercial arm) and Devas Multimedia for S-band spectrum. Government cancelled deal in 2011 citing national security.

LOW

Kolkata Metro to get India's first underwater metro museum

GS2 History & Culture

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Exhibition showcasing tunnel construction technology to open at Howrah station by December 2026.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Museum part of East-West Metro Corridor project. To be located at Howrah Maidan station.

LOW

Ajanta Caves: ASI launches conservation project for 5 critically damaged murals

GS1 Environment

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Archaeological Survey of India deploys Italian restoration experts for UNESCO World Heritage site preservation.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Project focuses on Caves 1, 2, 16, 17, and 19. Murals date to 2nd century BCE to 5th century CE.

LOW

Indian Railways records highest freight loading in May 2026

GS3 Economy/Environment

■ NEWS TRIGGER

National transporter loads 135.6 million tonnes, marking 8.2% year-on-year growth.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Ministry of Railways released operational statistics. Coal traffic: 62.1 MT (45.8% of total).

LOW

ISRO to launch GSAT-20 communication satellite in July

GS3 Science & Technology

■ NEWS TRIGGER

High-throughput satellite to boost internet connectivity in remote areas and in-flight connectivity services.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Launch scheduled from Satish Dhawan Space Centre, Sriharikota using GSLV Mk-III. Satellite weighs 4,700 kg with 32 Gbps throughput capacity.

LOW

IIT-Madras develops AI model for early crop disease detection

GS3 Science & Technology

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Deep learning system identifies 15 crop diseases with 94% accuracy using smartphone images.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Research published in journal Computers and Electronics in Agriculture. Model trained on 87,000 images of rice, wheat, and cotton crops.

LOW

Coal India plans Rs.50,000 crore investment in renewable energy by 2030

GS3 Environment

■ NEWS TRIGGER

State-owned miner targets 15 GW solar and wind capacity as part of diversification strategy.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Board approved renewable energy roadmap. Investment through subsidiary Coal India Solar Ltd.

LOW

NCPCR flags 25% rise in child labour cases in 2025-26

GS3 Social
Issues

■ NEWS TRIGGER

National Commission for Protection of Child Rights reports increase in violations despite stricter laws.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Annual report covering April 2025-March 2026 period. Total cases: 18,450 across India.

LOW

Kaziranga releases annual rhino census: population stable at 2,613

GS1 International
Relations

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Assam's UNESCO site shows successful conservation despite flood challenges and poaching threats.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Census conducted March-April 2026 using drone technology and ground surveys. One-horned rhinoceros population increased by 23 from previous year.

LOW

Election Commission announces bypolls for 7 Assembly seats across 6 states

GS2 Polity &
Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Vacancies due to deaths and resignations to be filled; voting on July 10, counting July 13.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Seats: Badrinath (Uttarakhand), Rajahmundry East (Andhra Pradesh), Milkipur (UP), Dhupguri (West Bengal), Bageshwar (Uttarakhand), Erode East (Tamil Nadu), and Jalandhar West (Punjab). Model Code of Conduct in force from June 19.

LOW

Kerala: Heavy rainfall alert, IMD issues orange warning for 6 districts

GS1 Environment

■ NEWS TRIGGER

India Meteorological Department forecasts 115-204 mm rain in 24 hours; authorities on high alert.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Orange alert for Thiruvananthapuram, Kollam, Pathanamthitta, Alappuzha, Kottayam, and Idukki. Yellow alert for remaining 8 districts.

LOW

SEBI tightens disclosure norms for market rumours

GS3 Economy

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Market regulator mandates listed companies to confirm or deny material price-sensitive information within 24 hours.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Circular issued under LODR (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations. Applies to all listed entities on BSE and NSE.

LOW

Supreme Court: Public servants cannot claim privacy in corruption cases

GS4 Polity & Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Constitution Bench rules that reasonable expectation of privacy does not extend to evidence of quid pro quo arrangements.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Judgment delivered by 5-judge bench led by Chief Justice. Case involved interception of phone conversations of IAS officer and businessman in bribery case.

LOW

U.P. CM says truth will prevail in Ram Temple donations probe

GS2 History & Culture

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath said truth will prevail after Special Investigation Team completed probe into allegations of embezzlement of Ram Temple trust donations.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Government constituted SIT to conduct inquiry at request of trust. SIT tasked with distinguishing between truth and falsehood.

LOW

Trinamool faces fresh exits and arrests in West Bengal

GS2 History & Culture

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Almost six weeks after defeat in West Bengal Assembly election, desertions, resignations and arrests of Trinamool Congress leaders continue in State.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Former West Bengal Minister Jyoti Priya Mallick resigned from party citing failing health. Narendranath Chakraborty resigned as district president in Paschim Bardhaman district.

LOW

CPI(ML) Liberation protests cross-voting allegations in Jharkhand

GS2 Polity & Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Communist Party of India (Marxist-Leninist) Liberation general secretary Dipankar Bhattacharya wrote to Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge protesting against allegations of cross-voting in Rajya Sabha elections in Jharkhand.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Bhattacharya expressed protest against malicious propaganda against MLAs and attempted tarnishing of party's image. Said party is committed constituent of INDIA bloc.

LOW

Doctor sent to 2-day custody for domestic help's murder in Delhi

GS2 Polity & Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Delhi court remanded dermatologist Manish Gupta in police custody for two days for murdering his domestic help Mina Halder, 58.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

56-year-old doctor arrested from home in East of Kailash. Judicial Magistrate Anurag Chhabra allowed police plea.

LOW

Eight killed in lightning strikes across six Jharkhand districts

GS2 Polity & Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

At least eight people, including two women and two-year-old boy, killed in lightning strikes across six districts of Jharkhand.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Three killed in Hazaribag district. 30-year-old woman killed in Manhar village in Palamu.

LOW

Woman and son die as parked car rolls into Lahaul gorge

GS2 Polity & Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Family's holiday trip turned into nightmare when woman and 11-month-old son died after parked vehicle rolled backwards and plunged into gorge in Lahaul and Spiti district.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Deceased identified as Tanu Kumari, 26, and son Daksh Kumar, residents of Gurugram. Accident occurred near Gramphu on Koksar-Rohtang route on Wednesday when family halted to enjoy scenic surroundings while travelling from Manali towards Lahaul and Spiti district.

LOW

NEET aspirant dies in Indore under suspicious circumstances

GS2 International Relations

■ NEWS TRIGGER

21-year-old NEET aspirant Avantika Maurya died after falling from third floor of building in Madhya Pradesh's Indore.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Indore DCP (Zone-4) Sunil Kumar Mehta said she died under suspicious circumstances, police initiated investigation. Avantika, resident of neighbouring Dhar district, living in Indore with sister preparing for entrance exam.

LOW

Uproar over defacing of Ambedkar statue in Uttar Pradesh

GS2 Polity & Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Jajouli and adjoining villages in U.P.'s Kaushambi district on edge after statue of Dr. B.R. Ambedkar vandalised by miscreants late on Thursday.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Villagers, mostly Dalits, held sit-in protest at site, raised slogans and demanded strictest action against culprits. Police helped reinstall statue and persuaded demonstrators to end protests after promising action and assuring no repeat.

LOW

Security tightened for CJP's protest at Jantar Mantar

GS2 Polity & Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Security tightened across Delhi as Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) set to carry out second protest at Jantar Mantar on Saturday.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

CCTV cameras installed in area. 270 body-worn cameras and videographers to be deployed to monitor and record activities.

LOW

Man arrested in Chhattisgarh for brutally assaulting wife

GS2 Polity & Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

44-year-old man arrested for brutally assaulting wife in Chhattisgarh's Korea district on June 14.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Alleged he tied woman's limbs, partially disrobed her, shaved head, blackened face and forced her to drink son's urine over purported extramarital affair. Footage of shocking incident surfaced online.

LOW

ISRO to launch Earth Observation Satellite on June 28

GS3 Science & Technology

■ NEWS TRIGGER

ISRO announced launch of a new Earth Observation Satellite on June 28 from Sriharikota using PSLV rocket.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

ISRO will launch Earth Observation Satellite-08 on June 28. Launch vehicle is PSLV-C58 from Sriharikota.

LOW

Solar rooftop subsidy extended to commercial buildings

GS3 Economy

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Ministry of New and Renewable Energy extended solar rooftop subsidy scheme to commercial buildings from residential-only earlier.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

MNRE extended solar rooftop subsidy to commercial buildings. Earlier the subsidy was available only for residential installations.

LOW

Tamil Nadu announces free bus travel for women above 60GS2 Social
Issues**■ NEWS TRIGGER**

Tamil Nadu government announced free bus travel for women above 60 years in state-run transport corporations.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Tamil Nadu announced free bus travel for women above 60 years. The scheme covers all state-run transport corporation buses.

LOW

Rubber production declines 8% in 2025-26GS3 Economy/En
vironment**■ NEWS TRIGGER**

India's natural rubber production declined 8% in 2025-26 to 6.72 lakh tonnes due to unfavorable weather and labor shortage.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Natural rubber production declined 8% in 2025-26 to 6.72 lakh tonnes. The decline attributed to unfavorable weather conditions and labor shortage in Kerala.

LOW

Aquaculture insurance scheme launched for fish farmers

GS3 Environment

■ NEWS TRIGGER

National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD) launched insurance scheme for fish farmers covering climate risks and disease outbreaks.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

NABARD launched aquaculture insurance scheme covering fish farmers. The scheme covers climate risks, disease outbreaks, and production losses.

LOW

Gold prices touch Rs.68,000 per 10 grams in Delhi

GS3 Economy

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Gold prices in Delhi touched Rs.68,000 per 10 grams, the highest level in 2026, driven by global geopolitical tensions.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Gold prices in Delhi reached Rs.68,000 per 10 grams. This is the highest level recorded in 2026.

LOW

Kerala to digitize all land records by December 2026

GS2 Polity & Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Kerala government set December 2026 deadline for complete digitization of all land records across the state.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Kerala set December 2026 deadline for complete land record digitization. The project covers all 14 districts and involves scanning 2.3 crore land documents.

LOW

Archaeological excavation reveals 2000-year-old Buddhist site in MP

GS1 History & Culture

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Archaeological Survey of India excavation in Madhya Pradesh's Sagar district revealed a 2000-year-old Buddhist monastery and stupas.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

ASI excavation in Sagar district, Madhya Pradesh revealed 2000-year-old Buddhist site. The site includes a monastery, stupas, and residential quarters.

LOW

Kathakali performer awarded Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship

GS1 History/Geography/Society

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Veteran Kathakali performer Kalamandalam Gopi was awarded Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship, the highest honor in performing arts.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Kalamandalam Gopi awarded Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship. This is the highest honor in performing arts in India.

LOW

Meghalaya launches bamboo mission for livelihood enhancement

GS2 Social Issues

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Meghalaya government launched State Bamboo Mission with Rs.250 crore allocation to enhance tribal livelihoods through bamboo-based industries.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Meghalaya launched State Bamboo Mission with Rs.250 crore allocation. The mission aims to enhance tribal livelihoods through bamboo-based industries.

LOW

Coastal Regulation Zone notification amended for ports

GS3 Economy/Environment

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Ministry of Environment amended Coastal Regulation Zone notification to allow expansion of major ports without additional environmental clearances.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

MoEFCC amended CRZ notification for port expansion. Major ports can now expand within existing boundaries without additional clearances.

LOW

Millets export crosses Rs.2,500 crore in FY 2025-26

GS3 Economy

■ NEWS TRIGGER

India's millet exports crossed Rs.2,500 crore in FY 2025-26, registering 34% growth driven by global health food demand.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

India's millet exports reached Rs.2,500 crore in FY 2025-26. Exports grew 34% year-on-year.

LOW

Nagaland extends ceasefire with NSCN-IM by one year

GS2 Internal Security

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Government of India extended ceasefire agreement with NSCN-IM by one year as peace negotiations continue.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Government extended ceasefire with NSCN-IM by one year until June 2027. Peace negotiations are ongoing for a final settlement.

LOW

National Organic Farming Policy draft released

GS3 Polity & Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Ministry of Agriculture released draft National Organic Farming Policy 2026 targeting 10 million hectares under organic cultivation by 2030.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Ministry of Agriculture released draft National Organic Farming Policy 2026. Target is to bring 10 million hectares under organic cultivation by 2030.

LOW

Plastic waste import ban to include medical plastic from July

GS3 Economy

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Government announced that import ban on plastic waste will include medical plastic waste from July 1, 2026.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Government extended plastic waste import ban to include medical plastic from July 1, 2026. Earlier medical plastic was exempted from the ban.

LOW

Coal production touches 900 million tonnes in FY 2025-26

GS3 Economy/Environment

■ NEWS TRIGGER

India's coal production touched 900 million tonnes in FY 2025-26, registering 7.2% growth over previous year.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Coal production reached 900 million tonnes in FY 2025-26. Production grew 7.2% compared to previous year.

LOW

Punjab to launch doorstep ration delivery scheme

GS2 Polity & Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Punjab government announced doorstep ration delivery scheme for senior citizens and differently-abled beneficiaries under PDS from August.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Punjab announced doorstep ration delivery for senior citizens and differently-abled beneficiaries. The scheme covers beneficiaries above 70 years and persons with disabilities.

LOW

Chhattisgarh announces teacher recruitment for tribal areas

GS2 Social Issues

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Chhattisgarh government announced recruitment of 5,000 teachers exclusively for schools in tribal-dominated areas.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Chhattisgarh announced recruitment of 5,000 teachers for tribal areas. The recruitment is exclusively for schools in Schedule V areas.

LOW

Shweta Menon-led AMMA committee resigns

GS2 Polity & Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Association of Malayalam Movie Artistes (AMMA) executive committee headed by Shweta Menon resigned amid internal turmoil.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

17-member panel stepped down after section moved no-confidence motion at general body meeting; leadership accused of failing to run day-to-day affairs and resolve disputes; committee elected in August 2025; Menon quit association alleging agenda to push her panel out.

LOW

Nihangs storm gurdwara in Rudraprayag, take manager hostage

GS3 Economy/Environment

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Group of Nihangs armed with spears and swords stormed gurdwara in Rudraprayag, took manager hostage on roof demanding release of four Nihang devotees arrested after Chamoli clash on June 16.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Stand-off began Saturday evening; heavy police force deployed; Rudraprayag DM and SP reached site; Nihangs locked third floor leading to terrace, remained on roof; engaged in vandalism.

LOW

Former Haryana CM Hooda warns of organised crime resurgence

GS2,GS3
General Studies

■ NEWS TRIGGER

LoP Bhupinder Singh Hooda described firing at Congress MLA Balram Dangi's Rohtak office as evidence of Haryana's crumbling law and order.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Police arrested one accused Aman of Lakhanmajra after brief encounter; Hooda said 50-60 gangs active across State; organised crime escalated to point where gangs openly claim responsibility showing no fear of law; Hooda visited firing site.

LOW

Himachal CM announces Rs.150 crore for medical college lab modernisation

GS2 Polity & Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Himachal Pradesh CM Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu announced Rs.150 crore corpus for modernisation of laboratories in medical colleges.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Announcement made while laying foundation stone of ultra-modern critical care block at Dr. Radhakrishnan Government Medical College campus at Jol Sapper in Hamirpur; campus coming up at cost of Rs.35 crore; block to become operational in first week of July.

LOW

Three injured in leopard attack in Rajasthan's Alwar

GS3 Environment

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Three persons injured after leopard attacked them in Ballupura village, Alwar district, Rajasthan.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Injured identified as Gila Yadav (45), Jairam Saini (40), Babli Yadav (39); Gila referred to district hospital due to severity of injuries; leopard first spotted in agricultural fields; group of villagers attempted to drive animal away following which it attacked.

LOW

Andhra Pradesh CM announces permanent yoga centres

GS2 Polity & Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

AP CM N. Chandrababu Naidu announced State's transformation into healthy, wealthy, happy State possible through yoga.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Speaking at State-level International Yoga Day events; Baba Ramdev guided session; Naidu resolved to create permanent yoga centres in Swarna Grama and Ward Secretariats with officials to supervise programmes.

LOW

Kerala Assembly to discuss Revised Budget 2026-27

GS2 Economy

■ NEWS TRIGGER

General discussion on Kerala's Revised Budget 2026-27 presented by CM V.D. Satheesan on June 19 to begin in Assembly.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Debate likely over next three days; Opposition LDF and BJP criticised budget for being flooded with announcements but lacking adequate allocations.

LOW

Andhra Pradesh forms SIT to probe custodial death

GS2,GS3
General Studies

■ NEWS TRIGGER

AP government constituted Special Investigation Team to inquire into alleged custodial death of Gade Sai Krishna in NTR Police Commissionerate limits.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

SIT constituted based on complaint by Sai Krishna's mother against Krishnalanka Circle Inspector S.S.V.V. Nagaraju; IGP M.

LOW

BJP, Congress engage in war of letters in Telangana

GS2 Polity &
Governance

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Political row between Congress and BJP after BJP State president N. Ramchander Rao sought appointment with Rahul Gandhi to discuss six guarantees implementation.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Ramchander Rao's letter came in response to CM Revanth Reddy's communication to Union Minister G. Kishan Reddy requesting facilitation of meetings with Union Ministers for approvals/clearances for Telangana projects including Hyderabad Metro Phase 2; Telangana PCC president Mahesh Kumar Goud accused BJP of attempting to divert attention from unfulfilled national-level promises; questioned BJP over black money promise and two crore jobs annually commitment.

LOW

Seven Naxals arrested in Jharkhand including PLFI area commander

GS3 Internal
Security

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Seven Naxals including area commander of banned outfit PLFI arrested in Jharkhand's Khunti district.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Operation by security forces in Khunti; area commander among those arrested.

LOW

Goa notifies 1.13 crore sq metres as no-development zone

GS3 Economy/Environment

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Goa government issued notification declaring nearly 1.13 crore square metres of eco-sensitive land as no-development zone.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Move aims to safeguard ecological assets and prevent indiscriminate development in environmentally fragile areas; notification issued by officials.

LOW

Maharashtra food poisoning: 79 still hospitalised

GS3 Social Issues

■ NEWS TRIGGER

Five days after major food poisoning outbreak in Bhiwandi town, 79 people continue treatment at local hospital.

■ INTRO & ORIGIN

Outbreak after consuming snacks at popular eatery; Food and Drug Administration launched crackdown on food joints, sealed prominent eatery in Thane district.

End of Register Notes — UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI